
COMPANION JOURNAL · VOLUME TWO

Walking with Jesus

Carry It With You - a guided companion journal

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IDC PUBLISHING · ISLAND DEVELOPMENT CREW

HOW TO USE THIS JOURNAL

- **Read first.** Each page pairs with the same day in the devotional - return to the printed Scripture before you write.
- **Two questions.** Observe what the verse says, then let it search your own story.
- **One small step.** A concrete response to complete before the day ends.
- **A written prayer.** Finish the starter line in your own hand - honesty over polish.
- **Month pages.** Each month opens with its theme, a planning calendar, a reading tracker, and space to sketch what you hear.

JANUARY

The Invitation to Follow

Move from admiring Jesus to walking with Him.

JANUARY • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ 1 Peter
- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Revelation
- ☐ John

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Lord Feeds the Worker He Sends

DAY 1

MATTHEW 10:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 7

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:10?

- ② What 'extra coat' of self-protection am I carrying right now because I don't fully trust God to provide, and what fear is underneath it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing you have been over-preparing or worrying about, and today deliberately set it down in prayer, choosing to go forward as a worker whose Master feeds him.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for being the God who feeds the workers You send -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Seals a Truth Until Its Hour

DAY 2

MARK 8:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 9

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:30?

- ② Where am I tempted to speak a truth to prove myself right or important, rather than to serve someone in love?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one thing you are eager to say today, and before you say it, pause to ask God whether this is His timing, and let His answer decide.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You hold the truth of who You are with perfect wisdom and perfect timing -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Speaks Your Name Before the Angels

DAY 3

LUKE 12:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 11

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:8?

- ② Where in my life have I kept my faith folded up and private because I feared what people would think?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one honest place today, a conversation, a decision, or a kindness, to let your belonging to Jesus be visible, and follow through on it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that when I confess You before others, You confess me before the angels of God -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord of the Vineyard Who Pays the Last First

DAY 4

MATTHEW 20:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 13

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:8?

- ② Whose blessing or mercy has stirred comparison or resentment in me lately, and what does that reveal about how I measure God's fairness?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, deliberately celebrate one good thing God has done for someone else, thanking Him for it out loud or in a note to that person.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord of the vineyard, thank You for a generosity that is bigger than my scorekeeping -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Reads the Worry Beneath Our Words

DAY 5

MARK 8:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 15

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:17?

- ② What shortage is my worry rehearsing right now, and what specific mercy from God have I forgotten while rehearsing it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down three concrete times God has provided for you in the past, and read the list aloud the next time anxiety about lack rises.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You see the worry hidden beneath my words, and You are not fooled by my calm surface -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Has Need of What You Hold

DAY 6

MATTHEW 21:3 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 17

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:3?

- ② What am I holding tightly, whether time, money, a plan, or a gift, that I sense the Lord may be asking to use?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one thing in your hands today and make it available to God's purposes, whether by giving, offering, or laying down a plan you were guarding.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You own everything, yet You honor me by having need of what I hold -" finish the line in your own words.

Jesus, the Bright and Morning Star

DAY 7

REVELATION 22:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 19

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:16?

- ② What darkness have I grown so practiced at studying that I've stopped looking for the dawn Jesus promises?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before you engage your worries today, spend the first few minutes fixing your attention on who Jesus is, naming His character aloud before you name your troubles.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the root and the offspring of David, the bright and morning star -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Keeps the Hour and Bids Us Stay Awake

DAY 8

MATTHEW 25:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 21

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:13?

- ② Do I lean toward spiritual sleep or spiritual panic when I don't know how or when God will act, and what would restful readiness look like instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, replace one anxious attempt to control an outcome with a deliberate act of staying near to Jesus, through prayer, worship, or Scripture, keeping your lamp lit while you wait.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You keep the day and the hour safely in the Father's hand, and You call me simply to watch -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Stops for the Man the Crowd Steps Around

DAY 9

MARK 10:46 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 23

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:46?

- ② Who around me have I been stepping past without truly seeing, and where do I myself feel unseen by the crowd?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, deliberately stop for one overlooked person: greet them, ask a real question, or offer help, the way Jesus stopped for Bartimaeus.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are never too busy for the person the crowd overlooks -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Leads Us Through Every Change of Ground DAY 10

MATTHEW 19:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 25

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 19:1?

- ② What transition or ending am I facing that makes me feel like I've left God behind in the old, familiar place?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one grace or lesson from your last season and deliberately carry it into today's new ground, writing it down and acting on it once.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You finish what You begin and then lead Your people on to new ground -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Takes Seriously What Trips His Little Ones DAY 11

LUKE 17:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 27

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 17:1?

- ② Whose faith or trust might my words, habits, or example be tripping, even unintentionally?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one habit or pattern of speech that could be a stumbling block to someone watching you, and take one concrete step today to clear it out of the way.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You take seriously everything that trips and wounds Your little ones, and I want to take it seriously too -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Looks Around and Names Us Kin

DAY 12

MARK 3:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 29

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:34?

- ② Where does the feeling of not belonging still shape how I see myself, even as one Jesus has named His family?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out today to one person in the family of faith, with a call, a visit, or an invitation, living out the belonging Jesus gives instead of doing faith alone.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for looking round the room and calling ordinary, obedient people Your family -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Calls Us to Take Up the Cross and Follow

DAY 13

MATTHEW 10:38 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 31

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:38?

- ② What comfort, approval, or control is quietly ruling my heart and keeping me at an admiring distance from truly following Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'cross', a self-protective habit or comfort, that Jesus is asking you to lay down today, and take one concrete step to follow Him instead.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You call me to take up my cross and follow, and I confess how often I would rather admire You from a comfortable distance -" finish the line in your own words.

The God of All Grace Who Mends What Suffering Tore

DAY 14

1 PETER 5:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 33

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in 1 Peter 5:10?

- ② Am I spending this season rehearsing an old wound, or listening for the restoration God says He is doing after it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one broken place you have been trying to fix by your own strength, and today deliberately hand it to the God who mends, in prayer, and by taking one small step toward healing rather than replaying the hurt.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"God of all grace, You do not only comfort the broken, You mend them -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Whose Likeness Is Enough for the Disciple

DAY 15

MATTHEW 10:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 35

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:25?

- ② What am I chasing, whether to be ahead, admired, defended, or exempt, that reveals I've wanted more status than Jesus Himself accepted?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one situation today where you'll deliberately stop competing for status and instead aim only to respond the way Jesus would, and act on it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, quiet the restless chase to be more than others, and teach me that being like You is enough -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Welcomes an Honest Word About the Cost DAY 16

MARK 10:28 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 37

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:28?

- ② What have I given up to follow Jesus that has quietly cost me, and have I been honest with Him about the ache, or hidden it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one real cost of following Jesus to Him in honest prayer today, naming it plainly without bargaining, and ask Him to help you trust His goodness with it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You welcome the honest heart, so I bring You mine -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Says Come and Holds You on the Water

DAY 17

MATTHEW 14:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 39

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:29?

- ② Where is Jesus saying 'Come' while I keep waiting to feel brave enough before I move?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one step of obedience today that you've been postponing until you 'felt ready,' trusting the word of Jesus rather than your own confidence to carry you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when life calls me onto water I could never walk on my own, remind me that the power is in Your word, not my courage -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Whom the Heart Comes to Know for Sure

DAY 18

JOHN 6:69 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 41

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in John 6:69?

- ② In what areas have I kept Jesus as an admired teacher at the edge, rather than the confessed Christ at the center?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one decision or worry today and deliberately hand it over to Jesus as Lord, acting as if you are truly sure He is the Christ, the Son of the living God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Christ, the Son of the living God, and I do not want to keep You at the edge of my life -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man Who Names the Hard Road and Walks It Still

DAY 19

MATTHEW 20:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 43

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:18?

- ② Where have I been editing God's harder words to make the road more comfortable, or resisting where Jesus is actually leading?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one area where following Jesus feels costly right now, and take one concrete step of obedience in it today rather than waiting for the path to get easier.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You named betrayal and the cross without slowing Your steps, because You could see past the hill to the joy beyond it -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Guards His Little Ones as Precious

DAY 20

MARK 9:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 45

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:42?

- ② Which 'little one', whether a child, a quiet servant, or a wounded or overlooked person, have I been tempted to dismiss, and how does Jesus see them?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Show deliberate honor to one easily overlooked person today, through patient attention, a kind word, or practical help, treating them as precious before God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You guard Your little ones with fierce and tender love, and You warn us not to despise them -" finish the line in your own words.

The Kingdom You Will See Before You Taste Death

DAY 21

LUKE 9:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 47

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:27?

- ② Where has the cost of following Jesus made you doubt the road leads anywhere - and what would change if you truly believed the kingdom waits at the end of it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one act of quiet obedience you have been tempted to abandon, and take that step today as one more mile toward the King.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for speaking truth to my weary heart -" finish the line in your own words.

Demanding a Sign From the One Standing Before You

DAY 22

MATTHEW 12:38 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 49

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:38?

- ② Where are you asking God for a sign about something He has already made clear - and is it truly proof you need, or the courage to obey?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take the one step of obedience you have been postponing until "the timing feels right," and take it today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have asked for another sign when You had already made Your will plain -" finish the line in your own words.

Dishonored at Home, Faithful Anyway

DAY 23

MARK 6:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 51

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:4?

- ② Whose disbelief or dishonor has tempted you to shrink back from what God is forming in you - and what would it look like to keep obeying anyway?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Instead of defending yourself to someone who has undervalued you, take one quiet step of obedience today that answers to God rather than to their opinion.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You know the ache of being dishonored by the very people who should have believed -" finish the line in your own words.

The Net That Fills, the Shore That Sorts

DAY 24

MATTHEW 13:48 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 53

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:48?

- ② What has drifted into your life and stayed simply because it came in with everything else - and is it feeding your fruitfulness or quietly choking it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing today that you have sensed you need to release, and take one concrete step to set it aside.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for a mercy that gathers me in and a truth that will not leave me careless -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Stands and Knocks

DAY 25

REVELATION 3:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 55

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:20?

- ② Where have I, like the lukewarm church, quietly left Christ standing outside a room of my life?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'closed room' you have kept Him out of, and today speak a simple prayer opening that door and inviting Him to sit with you there.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are still standing at the door, still knocking, still calling my name when I have grown cold -" finish the line in your own words.

Keep Watch, For You Know Not the Hour

DAY 26

MATTHEW 24:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 57

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 24:42?

- ② What has been shaping your attention before God ever gets to it - and how has that scattering dulled your awareness of the Lord?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one thing that regularly fills your mind first thing (a screen, the news, worry) and replace that first moment today with a few minutes of watchful prayer.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, my attention scatters so easily, and whole days slip by in noise -" finish the line in your own words.

Sent Ahead Into the Boat Before You Understand DAY 27

MARK 6:45 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 59

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:45?

- ② Where has Jesus sent you ahead into something you do not yet understand - and how might His firm leading actually be protecting you?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Instead of demanding to know the whole plan, take the next single step of obedience today and trust Him to meet you in the middle of it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when You send me forward before I understand why, help me trust that Your leading is love even when Your reasons are hidden -" finish the line in your own words.

The Prayer That Came Too Late at the Shut Door DAY 28

MATTHEW 25:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 61

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:11?

- ② Where have you been relying on borrowed faith or a "later" that keeps not coming, instead of drawing near to Jesus yourself today?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one personal, unborrowed act of devotion today - a prayer, a passage, an obedience that is yours alone - rather than saving it for a better time.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, keep me from living on borrowed faith and saving my nearness to You for later -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Even David Called His Lord

DAY 29

LUKE 20:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 63

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 20:42?

- ② Where has Jesus become a familiar topic to you rather than a living Lord - and what wonder have you lost by shrinking Him to fit your understanding?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Set aside a few minutes today simply to behold Christ enthroned - not asking Him for anything, only worshiping Him for who He is.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for shrinking You to a familiar size and treating You as a subject I have finished learning -" finish the line in your own words.

The Risen Life Larger Than Your Question

DAY 30

MARK 12:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 65

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:25?

- ② What are you clenching too tightly out of fear of loss - and how does the promise of resurrection life invite you to loosen your grip?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one fear or loss you have been carrying, and today entrust it in prayer to the God who raises the dead, releasing your grip one finger at a time.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess I picture the life to come as merely this one stretched longer, and so I clench my fears too tightly -" finish the line in your own words.

They Went and Did As Jesus Commanded

DAY 31

MATTHEW 21:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 67

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:6?

- ② What plain, already-clear step of obedience have you been complicating with a need for more information or certainty?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do the one simple thing Jesus has already made clear to you today - the errand, the conversation, the act - without waiting to understand how it all fits.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, teach me the beauty of plain obedience -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

January in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from January speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 1 • MATTHEW 10:10 + DEUTERONOMY 29:5

The Lord Feeds the Worker He Sends

Forty years, nothing wore out. The God who kept Israel's clothes and sandals whole through forty wilderness years is the same Lord who sends His workers out without a second coat. Provision has always traveled with obedience, not with baggage.

DAY 16 • MARK 10:28 + PHILIPPIANS 3:7

The Lord Who Welcomes an Honest Word About the Cost

Peter's ledger, Paul's total. Peter lays the account before Jesus - we have left all. Paul, further down the same road, runs the numbers again and writes gain in the loss column: everything surrendered for Christ turns out to be profit.

DAY 31 • MATTHEW 21:6 + EXODUS 40:16

They Went and Did As Jesus Commanded

Moses' pattern, the disciples' path. "Thus did Moses... so did he" and "the disciples went, and did as Jesus commanded" are the same plain music. God has always built His holy story out of ordinary people simply doing the thing He said.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from January keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

FEBRUARY

Learning His Voice

Let the words of Jesus become louder than approval and fear.

FEBRUARY • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

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8	9	10	11	12	13	14
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29						

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

☐ Matthew

☐ Luke

☐ Mark

☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

Enter Into the Joy of Your Lord

DAY 32

MATTHEW 25:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 69

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:23?

- ② Has your service to God become grim duty bracing for a verdict - and what would change if you truly believed His final word over you is "enter into My joy"?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one act of service today deliberately from joy rather than dread, pausing first to remember you are welcomed, not being graded.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have served You with my shoulders tensed, afraid the final word over me would be disappointment -" finish the line in your own words.

Many Will Come in His Name and Deceive

DAY 33

MARK 13:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 71

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:6?

- ② What voice have you been listening to that sounds spiritual but leaves you anxious rather than anchored in Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one message or teaching you have absorbed lately and test it today against the actual words of Jesus in Scripture, keeping what is His and releasing what is not.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to warn me that many will misuse Your name -"
finish the line in your own words.

Carrying the Word After the Teaching Ends

DAY 34

MATTHEW 13:53 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 73

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:53?

- ② What word from Jesus have you recently heard and admired but left behind instead of carrying into your days?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one truth you have learned recently and deliberately carry it through today - write it where you will see it, and return to it before each major moment.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I am quick to hear You and quick to move on, and too often Your word is left in the room where I heard it -" finish the line in your own words.

The God Who Counts the Hairs on Your Head

DAY 35

LUKE 12:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 75

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:7?

- ② Where has the fear of being overlooked driven you to strive - and how does it change things to know God has already counted every hair on your head?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Each time you catch yourself striving to be noticed today, pause and speak Luke 12:7 back to your own heart, laying that particular fear down.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, thank You that You know me so completely that even the hairs of my head are numbered -" finish the line in your own words.

The Warning Meant to Keep Your Heart Soft

DAY 36

MARK 3:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 77

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:29?

- ② Have you carried a secret dread of having gone too far - and how does it change things to see your very grief as the Spirit still tenderly drawing you?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring to God today, in honest repentance, the one thing conviction keeps pressing on your heart, answering His voice instead of hiding from it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Holy Spirit, thank You that Your conviction is mercy, drawing me home rather than shutting me out -" finish the line in your own words.

What Comes Out of the Mouth Comes From the Heart

DAY 37

MATTHEW 15:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 79

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:18?

- ② What have your words under pressure revealed lately about the true condition of your heart's well?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before the first tense moment today, spend time abiding with Jesus, then respond in that one moment with the silence, honesty, or gentleness that comes from a heart at rest.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You know that my words reveal what my heart is holding -" finish the line in your own words.

The Voice Like a Trumpet That Found Him in Exile

DAY 38

REVELATION 1:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 81

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:10?

- ② In what "exile" - a season, a limitation, a loneliness you did not choose - have you assumed God's voice is out of reach?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Instead of waiting for better circumstances, set aside quiet time today in the very place that feels limiting, and listen for the Lord there.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that no exile puts me out of Your reach -" finish the line in your own words.

Herod Heard the Rumor But Never Met the Man

DAY 39

MATTHEW 14:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 83

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:1?

- ② What secondhand voices or anxious reports have you been letting shape you more than the actual voice of Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

When the noise rises today, step away from the chatter and go directly to Christ in prayer and Scripture, letting what He says settle the matter.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, it is possible to hear so much about You and never truly meet You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Word Sown Among Thorns

DAY 40

MARK 4:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 85

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 4:18?

- ② What "thorn" - worry, money, or the pursuit of success - has been quietly choking the word in your heart by promising you safety?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one specific care or pursuit that is crowding out your trust in God, and take one concrete step today to pull it up and give His word room.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You know how easily worry, money, and the chase for success crowd out Your word in me -" finish the line in your own words.

The King Who Clears Every Snare from His Field DAY 41

MATTHEW 13:41 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 87

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:41?

- ② What is the one thing I keep stepping over and calling harmless - and what would it look like to let Jesus name it as the snare it really is?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name that one compromise out loud to God today, and take a single concrete step to remove it instead of excusing it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your holiness is mercy and not cruelty -" finish the line in your own words.

Not One Stone Will Be Left Standing

DAY 42

MARK 13:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 89

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:2?

- ② What impressive but temporary thing have I been quietly trusting to hold my peace, and how would my heart change if I anchored it in Christ instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one 'immovable' thing you are leaning on today, and in prayer deliberately move your trust from it to Jesus.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to tell me the truth about what cannot last -"
finish the line in your own words.

Then Are the Children Free

DAY 43

MATTHEW 17:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 91

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:26?

- ② Where have I let responsibility become the way I prove I belong, and how would I serve differently if I truly believed I was already a beloved child?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one duty you have been carrying out of fear, and today do it as an act of freedom - because you belong, not to earn belonging.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for calling me free before You call me to work -" finish the line in your own words.

The Word You Cannot Edit Down

DAY 44

REVELATION 22:19 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 93

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:19?

- ② Which part of God's word have I been quietly trimming or avoiding, and what is my heart afraid it will cost me to receive it whole?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Open to a passage you tend to skip because it convicts you, read it slowly, and ask God what He wants to say through the part you've been avoiding.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, forgive me for the times I have edited Your word down to what I already prefer, keeping the comfort and skipping the correction -" finish the line in your own words.

When Good Seed Falls on a Beaten Path

DAY 45

MARK 4:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 95

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 4:4?

- ② What has been packing down the soil of my heart lately - disappointment, hurry, cynicism, or old pain - and how is it keeping God's word from sinking in?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Pick one true word you've heard recently but let slide off, sit with it in silence today, and ask God to press it down into your heart.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You keep sowing Your word over my life even when my heart has grown hard -" finish the line in your own words.

What the Enemy Snatches from the Surface

DAY 46

MATTHEW 13:19 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 97

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:19?

- ② When was the last time a word from God stirred me and then vanished by the end of the day - and what kept it from sinking deeper than my ears?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one verse today, write it down, and turn it over in your mind more than once, asking God to help you truly understand it before you move on.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for sowing Your word in my heart -" finish the line in your own words.

The Blood That Still Cries Out

DAY 47

LUKE 11:51 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 99

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:51?

- ② What correction have I been deflecting lately, and is my resistance protecting my growth or only protecting my pride?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Go back to someone whose correction you brushed off, or to God in prayer, and receive the hard word instead of defending yourself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to tell me the truth, even when it wounds my pride -" finish the line in your own words.

The Weight of Every Idle Word

DAY 48

MATTHEW 12:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 101

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:36?

- ② If I replayed my words from yesterday, what would they reveal about what is really happening in my heart?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one habit of speech - complaint, criticism, or a cutting joke - and today intentionally replace it with a word of grace.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for caring even about the small, careless words I forget -" finish the line in your own words.

The Question That Cannot Stay at a Distance

DAY 49

MARK 8:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 103

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:27?

- ② If I set aside every borrowed answer about Jesus, who do I honestly say He is - and where in my life does that confession not yet have authority?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

In your own words, tell Jesus today who He is to you, and name one area of your life where you will let His voice have the final say.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for asking me the question I cannot answer from a distance -" finish the line in your own words.

The Defilement That Rises from Within

DAY 50

MATTHEW 15:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 105

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:11?

- ② What am I keeping composed on the outside while it runs anxious, bitter, or proud underneath - and what would it mean to give Jesus the source instead of the surface?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Trace one recent harsh word or reaction back to its root in your heart, and bring that root - not just the behavior - to God in prayer.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You care about the hidden place where my words and reactions begin -" finish the line in your own words.

The Words That Will Outlast the Sky

DAY 51

MARK 13:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 107

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:31?

- ② What in my life feels like it is shaking right now, and what specific word of Jesus can I anchor to instead of the emotion of the hour?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one promise of Christ and return to it each time anxiety rises today, letting His word carry more weight than your circumstances.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your words outlast heaven and earth -" finish the line in your own words.

The Clarity That Comes Further Down the Road

DAY 52

MATTHEW 17:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 109

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:13?

- ② What past confusion or hard season am I only now beginning to understand - and how can I let that be wisdom instead of regret?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing you don't yet understand about your current season, and hand it to Jesus in prayer, choosing to keep walking with Him instead of demanding the answer today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You teach me in layers and give understanding in Your time -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Room That Was Clean but Empty

DAY 53

LUKE 11:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 111

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:25?

- ② Where have I mistaken getting my life in order for actually being filled with Christ's presence - and what empty room is waiting for Him to move in?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one area you recently 'cleaned up' and deliberately fill it with His presence today - through prayer, worship, or Scripture - rather than leaving it empty.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the grace that has swept and cleared so much in my life -" finish the line in your own words.

The Story Laid Beside a Tired Heart

DAY 54

MATTHEW 13:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 113

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:34?

- ② When my heart feels dull and tired, do I press harder or do I slow down enough to let Jesus reach me in a way I can actually receive?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Read one of Jesus' parables slowly today, picturing it beside your own life, and let the image - not effort - stir what has gone flat.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You know how to reach a weary, dull heart -" finish the line in your own words.

When 'We Have No Bread' Drowns Out His Voice

DAY 55

MARK 8:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 115

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:16?

- ② What lack am I counting so loudly right now that it is drowning out what God is actually saying to me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

When anxiety over what you lack rises today, pause and recall one specific time God provided, letting that memory quiet the counting.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being the Bread of Life who sits with me even when I am counting what I lack -" finish the line in your own words.

The Pillar That Goes No More Out

DAY 56

REVELATION 3:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 117

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:12?

- ② Where am I still scrambling to invent or prove my worth, and how would I live differently if I truly believed Christ has made me a pillar who goes no more out?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one way you chase approval to feel secure, and today make one choice from the steadiness of belonging to Christ instead.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for promising to make the overcomer a pillar that goes no more out -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Teaching Meant for Those Who Follow, Too

DAY 57

MATTHEW 23:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 119

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 23:1?

- ② When I hear a hard teaching, do I apply it to myself or quietly assign it to someone else - and what truth have I been sending away?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one of Jesus' warnings you usually think applies to others, and honestly ask how it applies to you today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to speak Your hard words to me and not only to others -" finish the line in your own words.

The Words That Will Be Given in the Hour

DAY 58

MARK 13:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 121

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:11?

- ② What hard conversation or pressured moment am I rehearsing in fear right now, and what would change if I trusted Christ to meet me in the hour instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name the conversation you're dreading, hand it to Jesus in prayer, and stop rehearsing the worst version - trusting Him to supply what you need when it comes.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for promising to meet me in the very moment I dread -" finish the line in your own words.

The Father's Call to Work Today

DAY 59

MATTHEW 21:28 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 123

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:28?

- ② Do I hear God's call to serve as cold pressure or as a father's tender invitation - and how would that change the way I say yes?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify the one vineyard task the Father is calling you to today, and take the first concrete step to actually do it, not just agree to it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for calling me to work in Your vineyard not as a hired hand but as Your beloved child -" finish the line in your own words.

The Word He Spoke Before the Cross

LEAP DAY

MATTHEW 17:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 125

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:22?

- ② Where have I only wanted to follow Jesus into comfort and answers, and pulled back when He speaks of the harder road?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Use this extra day to sit quietly with one hard truth about your life you have been avoiding, and honestly surrender it to Jesus.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the costly love that let You be handed over for me -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

February in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from February speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 32 • MATTHEW 25:23 + LUKE 16:10

Enter Into the Joy of Your Lord

Little things, large trust. Luke names the principle and Matthew shows the welcome: whoever is faithful in the least is trusted with much, and the trusting comes wrapped in the master's own joy. The few things were never small to the Lord watching how they were held.

DAY 46 • MATTHEW 13:19 + PROVERBS 2:1

What the Enemy Snatches from the Surface

Hide the word; keep the word. Wisdom's counsel is to receive the words and hide them within - treasure buried too deep for a thief. What Jesus mourns in the wayside hearer, the proverb prevents: a word hidden in the heart cannot be snatched off the surface.

LEAP DAY • MATTHEW 17:22 + LUKE 24:6

The Word He Spoke Before the Cross

Spoken in Galilee, remembered at the tomb. The hard word Jesus gave in Galilee is the very word the angel recalls at the empty grave: remember how He told you. What sounded like defeat was resurrection reading its own itinerary.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from February keeps returning to you, and why?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

MARCH

The Way of the Kingdom

Receive the surprising values of the King in ordinary life.

MARCH • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

☐ Matthew

☐ Luke

☐ Mark

☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Lord Who Answers a Three-Word Prayer

DAY 60

MATTHEW 15:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 127

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:25?

- ② Where have I been performing strength instead of kneeling honestly before Jesus with my real need?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one burden out loud in prayer today using the mother's own words, "Lord, help me," and leave it at His feet.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I am done pretending I can carry this alone -" finish the line in your own words.

The Teacher Even His Enemies Called True

DAY 61

MARK 12:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 129

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:14?

- ② Where do I soften the truth or flatter others because I am afraid of losing approval?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

In one conversation today, say the honest, kind thing you have been avoiding, and trust God with the outcome.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You were true in the temple and true on the road, never bought by flattery, never bent by fear -" finish the line in your own words.

The Debt You Cannot Pay

DAY 62

MATTHEW 18:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 131

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:25?

- ② What guilt or failure have I been trying to work off instead of surrendering to Christ's mercy?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Confess to God one specific debt you cannot repay, receive His forgiveness by faith, and then release one person who owes you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Merciful Lord, I stop pretending my debt is small -" finish the line in your own words.

A Divided Kingdom Cannot Stand

DAY 63

LUKE 11:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 133

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:18?

- ② Where in my life are my words and my choices pointing in two different directions?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one area of divided loyalty today and take a single concrete step to bring it fully under Christ.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I am tired of being pulled in two directions -" finish the line in your own words.

The Courage That Waits for Jesus to Say Come

DAY 64

MATTHEW 14:28 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 135

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:28?

- ② Where am I tempted to move on impulse to prove myself, instead of waiting to hear from Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one pending decision to God today and ask Him for His word before you act on it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, teach me the difference between faith and impulse -" finish the line in your own words.

When You Hear of Wars, Be Not Troubled

DAY 65

MARK 13:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 137

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:7?

- ② How has fear over things I cannot control been setting the tone of my days?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, when an alarming thought or headline hits, pause and pray one honest sentence to the God who holds the end before you react.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, the news is loud and fear wants to run my house -" finish the line in your own words.

The King Who Takes His Throne

DAY 66

MATTHEW 25:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 139

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:31?

- ② What injustice or lasting pain have I stopped bringing to God because it feels like it will never change?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one situation you long to see set right, and entrust it today to the King who is coming in glory.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when injustice feels endless and pain feels permanent, remind me that You are coming in glory to set all things right -" finish the line in your own words.

Every Eye Shall See Him

DAY 67

REVELATION 1:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 141

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:7?

- ② What am I straining to protect or impress that will not matter on the day every eye sees Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Surrender one prideful hurry today and do one quiet, unseen act of obedience for the coming King.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are coming with clouds, and one day every eye will see You, and I will be among them -" finish the line in your own words.

The Day the Angels Divide the Just from the Wicked

DAY 68

MATTHEW 13:49 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 143

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:49?

- ② What have I told myself does not matter that the nearness of Christ is asking me to bring into the light?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Confess one secret compromise today and take one concrete step to walk in the light instead.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You speak plainly about the end because You love me too much to leave me deceived -" finish the line in your own words.

When Jesus Came Back Home

DAY 69

MARK 6:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 145

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:1?

- ② Where has familiarity dulled my expectation that God will speak to me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Return today to a well-worn Scripture or routine and ask Jesus, with fresh eyes, to show you something new.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the places I have stopped expecting to hear from You because they feel too familiar -" finish the line in your own words.

They Did Not Understand, So They Came and Asked

DAY 70

MATTHEW 13:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 147

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:10?

- ② What honest question have I been afraid to bring to Jesus, and how might carrying it to Him change me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one why you are wrestling with, bring it to God in prayer today, and choose to keep walking with Him without the full answer.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess I want to understand everything before I trust You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man Is Not Ashamed of the Unashamed

DAY 71

LUKE 9:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 149

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:26?

- ② Where have I softened or hidden my faith to stay comfortable in the crowd?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Speak one honest word about Jesus today in a place where you have usually stayed silent.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive the quiet ways I have distanced myself from You to keep a room comfortable -" finish the line in your own words.

The Teacher Who Preached from a Fishing Boat

DAY 72

MARK 4:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 151

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 4:1?

- ② What perfect conditions have I been waiting for before I expect God to speak to me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one ordinary part of today, a commute, a chore, a wait, and deliberately open it as a place to listen for Jesus.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for waiting on perfect conditions to hear from You -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Disciples Asked Who Was Greatest

DAY 73

MATTHEW 18:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 153

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:1?

- ② What 'who is the greatest' scoreboard am I secretly running, and what would change if I brought that question honestly to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Notice one comparison you make today, and answer it with a hidden act of service that no one will applaud.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, like Your first disciples I so often come measuring myself against everyone else, aching to know where I rank -" finish the line in your own words.

The King Hidden in the Sick and the Prisoner

DAY 74

MATTHEW 25:39 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 155

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:39?

- ② Who is the overlooked person God may be asking me to truly see and serve right now?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out today to one sick, lonely, or struggling person with a personal act of care.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for looking for You only in the grand and missing You in the lowly -"
finish the line in your own words.

When Fear Mistook Jesus for a Ghost

DAY 75

MARK 6:49 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 157

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:49?

- ② What in my life has fear been misnaming, reading God's help or presence as a threat?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one fear-distorted situation today and ask Jesus to show you where He is actually at work in it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, fear has a way of misnaming things, turning Your nearness into something I dread -" finish the line in your own words.

What the Heart Stores, the Life Spends

DAY 76

MATTHEW 12:35 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 159

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:35?

- ② What have I been storing in my heart that is now showing up in my words and reactions?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Deliberately store one good thing today, a passage of Scripture, a prayer, an act of gratitude, into your heart.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You see the storehouse of my heart, what I feed on, replay, and return to in secret -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Commandments Are Love Made Plain

DAY 77

LUKE 18:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 161

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 18:20?

- ② Where have I kept my faith spiritual and vague while letting my daily conduct quietly drift?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one commandment Jesus named and obey it concretely today toward a specific person.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess I like my faith vague because vague faith costs so little -" finish the line in your own words.

Grace Grows Only in Motion

DAY 78

MATTHEW 25:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 163

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:29?

- ② What gift, calling, or resource have I buried out of fear instead of putting to work for God?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one concrete step today to use a gift you have been holding back: offer it, start it, or give it away.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for burying Your gifts out of fear and calling it safety -" finish the line in your own words.

Is This Not Just the Carpenter?

DAY 79

MARK 6:3 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 165

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:3?

- ② What have I dismissed as too ordinary to be from God, or what label from others have I let define me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Look for God today in one humble place you would normally overlook, and respond to it with faith.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have missed You because You came in plain packaging -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Will Not Take Second Place

DAY 80

MATTHEW 10:37 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 167

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:37?

- ② Which relationship in my life have I quietly placed on the throne that belongs to Jesus, and what fear keeps me from surrendering it to Him?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one person you love deeply and pray over them today, releasing them into Jesus' hands instead of gripping them in your own.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You alone have the right to ask for first place in my heart, and today I give it to You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Keeps You Through the Hour

DAY 81

REVELATION 3:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 169

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:10?

- ② Where am I tempted to take the shorter, easier road right now, and what would it look like to trust Jesus to keep me instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one area of obedience you have stayed faithful in, and thank Jesus today for being the One keeping you in it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Faithful Lord Jesus, thank You for keeping what belongs to You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Warns You Before the Blow

DAY 82

MATTHEW 10:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 171

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:17?

- ② What hard situation am I dreading, and how does it change things to know Jesus already sees the room I am walking into?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one place you feel opposition for your faith, and ask Jesus today to prepare your heart to stand there without fear.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to tell me the truth -" finish the line in your own words.

The Heir the Grasping Hearts Refused

DAY 83

MARK 12:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 173

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:7?

- ② What am I gripping so tightly out of fear, and where has my gratitude quietly turned into control?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one thing you have been clutching and pray, releasing it back to Jesus as a gift to steward rather than a possession to defend.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Heir of all things, and I confess how tightly I grasp at what was never mine to seize -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord You Can Ask After You Have Failed

DAY 84

MATTHEW 17:19 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 175

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:19?

- ② What recent failure have I been hiding from God, and what would it look like to bring that honest question to Him instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one failure you feel ashamed of and talk to Jesus about it plainly today, asking Him what He wants to teach you through it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when I have failed and shame tells me to hide, help me come to You instead -"
finish the line in your own words.

The King Who Answers the Cry of Hosanna

DAY 85

MARK 11:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 177

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:9?

- ② Where have I been asking God to rescue me only in the shape I decided on, and how might His deeper answer look different?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one situation you have been crying out over, and pray surrendering the how and the when of the rescue to Jesus the King.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I cry out to You for rescue, and I confess how often I want it only on my own terms -" finish the line in your own words.

The Teacher Who Asks, Have You Understood?

DAY 86

MATTHEW 13:51 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 179

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:51?

- ② What truth has Jesus been bringing back around in my life, and have I been pretending to understand it instead of asking Him to teach me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Pick one thing about faith you are genuinely confused about and bring the honest question to Jesus and a trusted believer today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being a Teacher patient enough to ask whether I have understood -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Kingdom That Comes by One Finger of God

DAY 87

LUKE 11:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 181

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:20?

- ② What have I been fighting in my own strength that only the power of God can break, and have I truly handed it to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one stronghold in your life and pray over it today, asking Jesus to bring the power of His kingdom against it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have been measuring my strength against things far too strong for me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Will Not Trim the Truth to Spare Pride

DAY 88

MATTHEW 15:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 183

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:12?

- ② Whose approval have I been protecting by softening the truth, and where is the fear of man quietly ruling my words?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one truth you have been avoiding out of fear of offending, and ask Jesus for the courage to speak it in love this week.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You never trimmed the truth to spare a proud heart, and I confess how often the fear of man has ruled mine -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man Who Must Suffer and Rise

DAY 89

MARK 8:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 185

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:31?

- ② What suffering have I been trying to go around, and how does it change things to know Jesus walked through the deepest pain for me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one grief or hard place to Jesus today and ask Him to help you trust the resurrection He has promised on the far side of it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You did not go around suffering but walked straight through it to save me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Meets You First With a Question

DAY 90

MATTHEW 17:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 187

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:25?

- ② Where do I react defensively out of fear instead of resting as a child of the Father, and what is that fear really about?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

The next time you feel yourself bracing to defend, pause and ask Jesus, 'What do You want me to see here?' before you respond.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for meeting me before my reactions do -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

March in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from March speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 60 • MATTHEW 15:25 + GENESIS 32:26

The Lord Who Answers a Three-Word Prayer

Two wrestlers who would not let go. Jacob at the Jabbok and this mother at Jesus' feet hold on the same way: I will not let You go without a blessing. Heaven does not call that rudeness - heaven calls it faith.

DAY 75 • MARK 6:49 + JOB 9:8

When Fear Mistook Jesus for a Ghost

Job named the feet on the waves. Job said God alone treadeth upon the waves of the sea - so the figure the disciples feared was wearing heaven's own signature. Fear called Him a ghost; Scripture had already called Him Lord.

DAY 90 • MATTHEW 17:25 + LUKE 10:36

The Lord Who Meets You First With a Question

The Teacher who asks first. 'What thinkest thou, Simon?' and 'Which now of these three, thinkest thou?' are the same Teacher at work. Jesus forms sons by drawing out their reasoning under His gaze, not by demanding compliance without understanding.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from March keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

APRIL

Mercy at the Table

Meet the Jesus who welcomes, feeds, and restores people.

APRIL • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ 1 Peter
- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Forgiven Servant Who Would Not Forgive

DAY 91

MATTHEW 18:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 189

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:30?

- ② Who am I holding in a prison of unforgiveness, and how does remembering my own forgiveness change the way I see their debt?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one person you resent and take a first step toward release today - pray for them by name and ask God to soften your will.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Merciful Lord, I have received more grace than I could ever repay, and yet I still clutch the small debts others owe me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Gathered the Unlikely Together

DAY 92

MARK 3:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 191

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:18?

- ② Who have I quietly kept at arm's length because their story or style of faith differs from mine, and what would making room look like?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out today to one believer who is very different from you, and thank God for the gift they bring to the body of Christ.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for gathering the unlikely - for seating enemies at one table and calling every kind of person to follow You -" finish the line in your own words.

The God From Whom Nothing Stays Hidden

DAY 93

LUKE 12:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 193

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:2?

- ② What hidden thing - done to me or by me - am I anxiously carrying, and what would it mean to trust the God from whom nothing stays hidden?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one secret worry into the light today by praying it honestly to God, and if it is your own, confess it and let it go.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord, when I am afraid of what others hide, remind me that nothing is covered before Your eyes -" finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Was Moved to Cancel the Debt

DAY 94

MATTHEW 18:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 195

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:27?

- ② What guilt or debt am I still trying to repay to God, even though His compassion has already cancelled it in full?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one thing you have been condemning yourself for, then declare it forgiven in Christ and thank Him for your release.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have carried the weight of debts I could never repay, counting a bill You already cancelled at the cross -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Sets a Table in the Wilderness

DAY 95

MARK 8:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 197

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:4?

- ② Where am I facing a need far bigger than my resources, and have I brought the honest 'how?' to Jesus or let it turn into despair?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'wilderness' need today and place your small resource - your time, money, or strength - into Jesus' hands, asking Him to multiply it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I see needs far bigger than anything I can supply, and my hands feel empty -" finish the line in your own words.

The King We Meet at the Sickbed and the Prison Door

DAY 96

MATTHEW 25:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 199

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:36?

- ② Whose real, physical need have I been stepping over, and where has my love grown abstract and numb?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one concrete act of care today - visit, clothe, feed, or show up for someone - and do it as unto Jesus Himself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for keeping love at a comfortable distance and stepping over the needs right in front of me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Says, Hold Fast Your Crown

DAY 97

REVELATION 3:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 201

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:11?

- ② What precious thing - faith, integrity, hope, or calling - am I tempted to trade for something easier, and why?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'crown' Jesus has placed in your hands and take one concrete step today to hold it fast instead of drifting.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when I grow weary and tempted to trade away what You have given, remind me that You are coming quickly and coming for me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Shepherd Who Divides the Sheep From the Goats

DAY 98

MATTHEW 25:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 203

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:32?

- ② Has my faith stayed mostly private and inward, and where is Jesus asking my devotion to become visible in mercy?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one visible act of mercy today - for someone hungry, lonely, or overlooked - letting your love for Jesus take a shape others can see.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Shepherd who sees clearly what a life is made of -" finish the line in your own words.

The Shepherd Moved With Compassion for the Crowd

DAY 99

MARK 6:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 205

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:34?

- ② Have people become interruptions to me lately, or am I the one feeling shepherdless - and how does Jesus' compassion meet me right there?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Ask Jesus for His eyes today, then truly see and show compassion to one person you would normally overlook.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, Good Shepherd, forgive me for the numbness that turns people into interruptions -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Answers Buried Fear

DAY 100

MATTHEW 25:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 207

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:26?

- ② What gift, calling, or word has fear persuaded me to bury, and what excuse have I been calling wisdom?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one buried gift out of hiding today and use it in a single, concrete act of obedience.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to name the fear I have called caution -" finish the line in your own words.

The Heart That Whispers, My Lord Delays

DAY 101

LUKE 12:45 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 209

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:45?

- ② Where has long waiting quietly made me harsher, more self-protective, or more careless with the people I love?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Return to the Lord's table in prayer today, then do one deliberate act of tenderness toward someone you have grown short with.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You know how long the waiting has felt, and You see the quiet sentence my heart wants to whisper, that You have delayed -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Calls Us Children at the Narrow Door

DAY 102

MARK 10:24 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 211

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:24?

- ② What am I leaning my full weight on for security besides Jesus, and what happens in me when that thing is threatened?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one "riches" you have trusted, open your hands over it in prayer, and take one step that puts your trust in Christ instead.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for calling me Your child even while You tell me the truth -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Hidden in the Ones We Overlook

DAY 103

MATTHEW 25:44 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 213

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:44?

- ② Whose need has become invisible to me because I have grown too busy, too guarded, or too used to it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Ask Jesus to name one overlooked person today, then meet a concrete need of theirs before the day ends.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the days I walked past need and never saw You there -" finish the line in your own words.

The Cry of a Parent Who Cannot Fix It

DAY 104

MATTHEW 17:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 215

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:15?

- ② Who am I loving that I cannot fix, and where have I been trying to be their savior instead of carrying them to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one family burden to Jesus today by name, speaking the honest particulars, and release the pressure to rescue.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I bring You the one I love and cannot fix -" finish the line in your own words.

The Cup of Cold Water Heaven Remembers

DAY 105

MARK 9:41 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 217

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:41?

- ② What small act of kindness have I dismissed as too ordinary to matter to God?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Offer one deliberate cup-of-cold-water kindness today in Jesus' name, without needing anyone to notice.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You notice the cup of cold water when no one else does -" finish the line in your own words.

Chosen Together, Never Alone

DAY 106

1 PETER 5:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 219

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in 1 Peter 5:13?

- ② Where has the lie "no one remembers me" taken root, and how has it kept me from receiving the belonging Christ has already given?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out to one member of Christ's body today, and let yourself receive their fellowship in return.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You saved me into a family and not into solitude -" finish the line in your own words.

The Compassion That Reached Out and Touched DAY 107

MATTHEW 20:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 221

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:34?

- ② Where have I gone spiritually blind, and what have I stopped being able to see clearly of God's goodness?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one specific area of lost sight to Jesus in prayer today and ask Him plainly to restore your vision.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have gone blind in places I never expected, and I cannot see clearly on my own -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Glory That Shone Out from Within

DAY 108

MARK 9:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 223

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:2?

- ② What pressure is filling my whole view right now, and where do I need Jesus to show me His glory so I can face what is ahead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Come apart with Jesus today in a deliberate, quiet time away from the noise, and fix your attention on who He is before you return to the pressure.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for drawing me close before the hard seasons and letting me see who You really are -" finish the line in your own words.

The Welcome Prepared Before the World Began DAY 109

MATTHEW 25:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 225

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:34?

- ② Where am I still serving God as if I must earn a welcome that He prepared for me before the world began?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before serving anyone today, sit in the King's welcome in prayer, then let one act of mercy flow from rest instead of fear.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the kingdom was prepared for me before the world began, long before I could earn or ruin it -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Owns Our Rest

DAY 110

LUKE 6:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 227

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 6:5?

- ② Have I made rest impossible by striving, or made it a performance by rule-keeping, and what is Jesus inviting me to receive instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Give yourself one deliberate stretch of true rest and worship today, receiving it from the Lord of the sabbath rather than earning it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Son of man who knows my weariness, and You are Lord of my rest -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Forgave the Whole Debt

DAY 111

MATTHEW 18:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 229

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:32?

- ② What grudge am I still holding while living on mercy I never earned, and how would remembering "all that debt" change my grip?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one concrete step of forgiveness today toward a person you have kept at arm's length.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You forgave me all that debt when I could never have repaid it -" finish the line in your own words.

When Tradition Starts Measuring the Heart

DAY 112

MARK 7:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 231

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 7:5?

- ② Where have I let a human rule or checklist become my measure of faithfulness while my heart drifted from mercy?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Trade one act of religious performance today for one act of heartfelt mercy toward a person.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I polished the outside while my heart drifted far from mercy -" finish the line in your own words.

The Vineyard That Was Never Ours to Keep

DAY 113

MATTHEW 21:41 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 233

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:41?

- ② What has God entrusted to me that I have started clutching as if I owned it and its outcome?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Open your hands over one thing you have been gripping, and entrust it back to the Owner in prayer today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for treating what You entrusted to me as though I owned it -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Says, I Have Loved Thee

DAY 114

REVELATION 3:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 235

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:9?

- ② Where am I aching to be proven right, and how would resting in "I have loved thee" change the way I carry that wound?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Release one person who misjudged you into Christ's hands today, and refuse one invitation to bitterness in how you speak of them.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You see the truth even when everyone else has it wrong -" finish the line in your own words.

The Mercy That Lifts What Has Fallen into the Pit

DAY 115

MATTHEW 12:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 237

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:11?

- ② Where have I used being "right" as a reason to avoid getting involved in someone's real need?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Find one person stuck in a pit today and take one concrete action to help lift them out.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I protected an argument while a hurting person waited for help -" finish the line in your own words.

The Correction That Calls the Wanderer Home

DAY 116

MARK 12:24 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 239

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:24?

- ② Has my faith quietly come to rest on my feelings, opinions, or habits more than on God's Word and God's power?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Return to Scripture on one belief you have been holding loosely today, and let it correct or confirm you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to correct me instead of leaving me comfortably wrong -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Says, Give Ye Them to Eat

DAY 117

LUKE 9:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 241

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:13?

- ② What need have I been trying to send away because I decided I had too little to help?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring your "five loaves" to one real need today, offering the little you have instead of waiting until you feel like enough.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when the need in front of me feels too big, I want to send it away and call it someone else's problem -" finish the line in your own words.

The Kingdom That Begins with a Wedding Feast

DAY 118

MATTHEW 22:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 243

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:2?

- ② Has my faith felt more like a courtroom summons or a wedding invitation, and what has shaped that?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Extend the King's joy to one person today through an invitation, an encouragement, or a welcome that sounds like celebration rather than obligation.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for treating Your kingdom like a courtroom when You made it a wedding feast -" finish the line in your own words.

The Question That Left Them Silent

DAY 119

MARK 3:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 245

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:4?

- ② Where has my caution, or my busyness, kept me from simply doing the good that is in front of me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one clear, unhurried act of good today for someone who is hurting, without waiting for the "right" conditions.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times my caution became silence while good waited to be done -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Gives More to the Open Hand

DAY 120

MATTHEW 13:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 247

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:12?

- ② Where have I been holding back a 'small' yes to God because it felt too little to matter - and what would it mean to hand Him that little today?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one truth God has already shown you that you have not yet obeyed, and take one concrete step to answer it before the day ends.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that You give more to the heart that receives You -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

April in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from April speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 91 • MATTHEW 18:30 + PROVERBS 21:13

The Forgiven Servant Who Would Not Forgive

The closed ear goes unheard. Proverbs warns that whoever stops his ears at the cry of the poor will one day cry and not be heard. The forgiven servant lives out that proverb, jailing a debtor with hands mercy had just untied.

DAY 106 • 1 PETER 5:13 + 2 TIMOTHY 4:11

Chosen Together, Never Alone

Mark, wanted at both tables. The Marcus greeting the churches from Peter's side is the same Mark Paul asks for by name at the end: 'he is profitable to me for the ministry.' In Christ's household, restored names get written back into the greetings.

DAY 120 • MATTHEW 13:12 + LUKE 12:48

The Lord Who Gives More to the Open Hand

Given much, asked much. Jesus' sober word about receiving and losing finds its plain-spoken twin in Luke: unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required. Grace is a trust, and every truth He hands you is waiting on a living answer.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from April keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

MAY

Faith That Reaches for Jesus

Bring real need to the One who heals and makes whole.

MAY • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
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29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ 1 Peter
- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Teacher You Were Never Meant to Outrank

DAY 121

MATTHEW 10:24 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 249

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:24?

- ② Where has pride worn 'spiritual clothing' in my life - quoting truth while quietly refusing to be corrected by it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Think of one hard word someone recently spoke to you. Instead of defending yourself, bring it to Jesus today and ask what He wants to teach you through it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being a Master worth following and a Teacher I can trust -" finish the line in your own words.

The Healer They Plotted to Destroy

DAY 122

MARK 3:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 251

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:6?

- ② Where have I let someone's disapproval tempt me to regret a good and merciful thing I did?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one act of mercy or honesty you have been holding back for fear of the reaction. Do it today, and entrust the response to God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You did good even when it cost You everything -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Reads the Thought Behind the Words

DAY 123

LUKE 11:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 253

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:17?

- ② Where am I living divided right now - saying one thing to God or others while protecting something different underneath?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'divided place' honestly before Jesus today, out loud in prayer, and ask Him to begin mending it rather than hiding it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You know my thoughts before I speak them, and You love me still -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Moves the Mountain You Cannot

DAY 124

MATTHEW 17:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 255

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:20?

- ② What 'mountain' have I been straining to move in my own strength, blaming the smallness of my faith instead of trusting the greatness of God?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one impossible-looking situation and pray over it today, deliberately putting your focus on God's power rather than on the size of your faith.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have spent too long measuring my faith and finding it small -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Holds Both Ends of Your Story

DAY 125

REVELATION 1:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 257

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:8?

- ② What present pressure or old wound have I let become my whole horizon, as if it had the first and last word over my life?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one worry that feels final, then hand it to Jesus in prayer as the One who already stands at the end of your story.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Beginning and the Ending, the Almighty over all my days -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Says Leave It and Come

DAY 126

MARK 13:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 259

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:15?

- ② What do I keep 'climbing down to retrieve' that God has already told me to leave behind?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing you have been reaching back for and take one concrete step today to release it and move forward in obedience.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when You say move, give me the courage to go without reaching back -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Heals Along the Road

DAY 127

MATTHEW 19:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 261

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 19:2?

- ② Who have I been treating as 'background' while I hurry toward things I think matter more?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, deliberately slow down for one person in your 'in-between' hours - offer real attention, a kind word, or help - as Jesus healed on the way.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You gave mercy right on the road, never too busy to heal -" finish the line in your own words.

The Prison Unforgiveness Builds

DAY 128

MATTHEW 18:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 263

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:34?

- ② Where has holding on to an offense actually imprisoned me rather than protected me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one person you have been refusing to forgive and take one step toward release today - a prayer of forgiveness, a letting-go spoken aloud, or a move toward reconciliation.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You forgave me a debt I could never repay -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Leads Wounded Reasoning Home DAY 129

MARK 10:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 265

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:4?

- ② Where have I been searching for a 'permission' or loophole to avoid something God has actually asked of me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one area where pain has been driving your decisions, and bring it honestly to Jesus today, asking Him for His intention rather than an excuse.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are tender with wounded people and faithful enough to tell us the truth -"
finish the line in your own words.

The King Whose Feast They Would Not Come To DAY 130

MATTHEW 22:3 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 267

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:3?

- ② What invitation from God have I been quietly refusing - not with open rebellion, but with delay, busyness, or indifference?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one 'someday' step toward God you keep postponing and take the first concrete part of it today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Gracious King, thank You for an invitation I did nothing to earn -" finish the line in your own words.

The Servant Found Faithful When the Master Comes

DAY 131

LUKE 12:43 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 269

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:43?

- ② Where am I tempted to quit being faithful because no one seems to notice?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one hidden, unglamorous responsibility today and do it thoroughly and well, as unto the Lord who sees.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You see the faithfulness the world overlooks -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Cloud Lifts, Jesus Only

DAY 132

MARK 9:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 271

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:8?

- ② What 'competing centers' have been crowding out my focus on Christ lately?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take a few quiet minutes today to deliberately still the noise - turn off the screen, close the door - and fix your attention on Jesus alone before anything else claims first place.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, my heart gets so crowded with urgent voices and competing centers that I lose sight of You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Hand That Touches and Says, Do Not Be Afraid

DAY 133

MATTHEW 17:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 273

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:7?

- ② What fear has me 'face-down' right now, and can I picture Jesus kneeling beside me with His hand on my shoulder, saying 'Arise'?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one fear you have been lying under and take one concrete step of obedience today as your answer to His 'Arise, and be not afraid.'

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when fear has put me face-down, thank You that You come near, You touch, and You lift -" finish the line in your own words.

The Leader Who Leads by Example, Not by Force DAY 134

1 PETER 5:3 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 275

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in 1 Peter 5:3?

- ② Where in my relationships have I tried to control others out of my own fear, rather than leading them by example?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one person you influence and this week lead them by going first - model the gentleness, patience, or obedience you have been expecting from them.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Shepherd who leads by love and washes the feet You could have commanded -" finish the line in your own words.

The Grace You Received Free Is Meant to Be Given Free

DAY 135

MATTHEW 10:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 277

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:8?

- ② What have I been holding back - forgiveness, time, encouragement, resources - out of a fear that giving will leave me empty?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Recall one specific grace God gave you freely, then pass along something in kind today - forgive someone, give your time, or encourage a person who cannot repay you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for all the grace that reached me carrying no invoice - forgiveness, comfort, strength, and help right on time -" finish the line in your own words.

The Owner Who Comes Back to His Vineyard

DAY 136

MARK 12:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 279

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:9?

- ② What part of my life have I been treating as my own to rule, forgetting it was entrusted to me by God?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one 'corner' you have been guarding as private property and deliberately surrender it back to God today in prayer and in a concrete act of stewardship.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, everything I hold was entrusted to me, never owned by me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Stops for the Cry of the Desperate

DAY 137

MATTHEW 20:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 281

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:30?

- ② What need have I been dressing up or keeping at arm's length instead of crying out to Jesus about honestly?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one raw, unpolished need to God today in plain, desperate words - no performance, just an honest cry for mercy.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Tree Whose Leaves Heal the Nations

DAY 138

REVELATION 22:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 283

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:2?

- ② What weary or broken place in my life am I treating as the end of the story, when Jesus is leading it toward healing?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one exhaustion, division, or wound and consciously place it 'under the tree' - pray it forward today into the restoration Jesus is leading you toward.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when I am worn down and the story feels like it ends in the wound, remind me where the road is truly heading -" finish the line in your own words.

The Sword That Divides False Peace from True

DAY 139

MATTHEW 10:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 285

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:34?

- ② Where have I mislabeled avoidance or compromise as 'peace' to protect my own comfort?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one hard conversation or honest truth you have been dodging, and take one courageous, loving step toward it today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have called avoidance 'peace' and made my comfort the highest lord -" finish the line in your own words.

The Cry the Crowd Could Not Silence

DAY 140

MARK 10:48 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 287

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:48?

- ② Whose voice has trained me to quiet my prayers, and what need have I been afraid to bring to Jesus out loud?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one need you have been keeping polite and silent, and cry out to Jesus about it today without holding back.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Day Wears Away and the Place Is Empty

DAY 141

LUKE 9:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 289

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:12?

- ② Where am I measuring my situation only by what I can see and leaving Jesus out of the count?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one 'desert place' shortage in your life and pray over it, handing Him the little you do have.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess how quickly I start counting the shortage and forget that You are standing in the middle of it -" finish the line in your own words.

The Name Too Precious to Deny

DAY 142

MATTHEW 10:33 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 291

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:33?

- ② In what setting have I learned to hide Jesus to keep the peace or fit in, and what fear is underneath that silence?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one small, ordinary way to acknowledge Christ openly today instead of keeping quiet.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have made You small enough to hide -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Meets Us in the Forgotten Loaf

DAY 143

MARK 8:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 293

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:14?

- ② What small mistake or lack am I letting take over my peace, and what has Jesus already done that I have forgotten?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Hand Jesus one 'small' worry today, out loud, and thank Him for a past provision you had forgotten.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that no worry is too small to bring to You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Wedding Robe You Must Actually Wear

DAY 144

MATTHEW 22:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 295

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:13?

- ② Where am I near to holy things without letting grace all the way into my heart?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one area where your faith is 'appearance only' and take one real step of repentance or obedience there today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for an invitation I could never earn -" finish the line in your own words.

The New Song Heaven Sings to the Lamb

DAY 145

REVELATION 5:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 297

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 5:9?

- ② What 'old song' about myself have I been repeating, and what does the redeemed truth about me actually say?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Spend a few minutes today worshiping Jesus for redeeming you, out loud, before you feel any different.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Worthy Lamb, thank You that You were slain and by Your blood redeemed me for God -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Two Roads Jesus Takes Seriously

DAY 146

MATTHEW 25:46 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 299

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:46?

- ② Have I drifted toward casual, numb faith, or toward fearful, anxious faith, and how is Jesus calling me toward tender obedience instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Show concrete mercy to one 'least of these' person today as a response to the weight of His words.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to speak seriously -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Walks Ahead Into the Suffering

DAY 147

MARK 10:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 301

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:32?

- ② What truth have I been keeping vague because facing it feels like inviting the pain?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one hard reality honestly today and take the first obedient step onto that road, trusting Jesus is ahead of you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You do not hide the truth from the ones You love, and You do not send me down hard roads alone -" finish the line in your own words.

They Knew Not Until the Flood Came

DAY 148

MATTHEW 24:39 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 303

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 24:39?

- ② What is quietly lulling me to sleep spiritually, and where have I stopped paying attention to God in my ordinary days?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Build one 'waking' moment into today, a pause to pray, remember, and watch for Jesus, instead of running on autopilot.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for sleepwalking through the days You have given, living as if You never speak and never return -" finish the line in your own words.

The Colt Was Already Tied and Waiting

DAY 149

LUKE 19:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 305

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 19:30?

- ② What simple, clear thing has Jesus already told me to do that I have been overlooking while waiting for something bigger?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do that one 'small' act of obedience today without waiting for a dramatic feeling.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for waiting on something dramatic while ignoring the simple thing You have already asked -" finish the line in your own words.

When Suspicion Speaks Before Mercy Listens

DAY 150

MARK 2:24 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 307

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 2:24?

- ② Where has a critical, accusing voice, toward myself or others, been speaking faster than mercy in me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

The next time you notice a fault today, yours or someone else's, pause and respond with mercy before judgment.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for walking the road of mercy and not just pointing to it -" finish the line in your own words.

The King Who Comes to You Gentle

DAY 151

MATTHEW 21:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 309

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:5?

- ② Where do I push, posture, or prove myself instead of serving with the gentle strength of Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one situation today to serve quietly and humbly, without needing to be seen or to control the outcome.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, my gentle King, thank You for coming meek and lowly instead of with domination -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

May in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from May speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 121 • MATTHEW 10:24 + LUKE 6:40

The Teacher You Were Never Meant to Outrank

Under the Teacher, becoming like Him. Matthew sets the order: the student does not stand above the Master. Luke adds the promise hidden inside that order - stay teachable under Him long enough, and you will be shaped into His likeness.

DAY 136 • MARK 12:9 + ISAIAH 5:3

The Owner Who Comes Back to His Vineyard

The Owner asks for a verdict. In Isaiah the LORD invites Jerusalem to judge between Him and His vineyard; in Mark, Jesus raises the same court question about the tenants and then answers it Himself. Either way the verdict lands - and every honest steward feels their own case being read.

DAY 151 • MATTHEW 21:5 + ZECHARIAH 9:9

The King Who Comes to You Gentle

Five centuries between promise and hoofbeats. Zechariah told Zion her King would come lowly, riding a colt, and Matthew watches it happen in the street - gentleness was not a change of plan; it was the plan all along.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from May keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

JUNE

Prayer and Abiding

Stay near enough for prayer to become relationship.

JUNE • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

☐ Matthew

☐ Luke

☐ Mark

☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

She Cried Out for the One She Loved

DAY 152

MATTHEW 15:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 311

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:22?

- ② What burden, especially for someone I love, have I been carrying privately instead of crying out to Jesus about?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring that specific burden and that person to Jesus in honest prayer today, out loud.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Wound Comes From the Ones We Love DAY 153

MARK 13:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 313

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:12?

- ② What relational wound or broken relationship have I been carrying, and where have I let that pain convince me Jesus is distant?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name that hurt honestly to Jesus today, asking Him for courage and comfort instead of pretending it away.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You were betrayed by one who shared Your table, so You understand the wounds that come from those closest to me -" finish the line in your own words.

He Calls You Friend Before the Danger

DAY 154

LUKE 12:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 315

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:4?

- ② Whose disapproval or power have I let grow too large, and how has the fear of people been running my choices?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Make one decision today out of reverence for God rather than fear of someone's opinion.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for calling me Your friend before You ever spoke of the danger -" finish the line in your own words.

What Flesh and Blood Could Never Show You

DAY 155

MATTHEW 16:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 317

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 16:17?

- ② Where am I striving for certainty or comparing my faith to others instead of living in what God has already shown me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one truth about Jesus the Father has made clear to you, and make one decision today by living inside it rather than doubting it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, thank You that knowing Your Son is a gift You give, not a prize my cleverness must win -" finish the line in your own words.

Through the Gates and Home at Last

DAY 156

REVELATION 22:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 319

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:14?

- ② Where has shame convinced me I belong outside the welcome God is actually extending to me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one step 'through the gate' today, coming to God in worship or fellowship you have been avoiding because you felt unwelcome.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for opening the way home -" finish the line in your own words.

He Comes Walking on the Storm in the Dark

DAY 157

MARK 6:48 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 321

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:48?

- ② In what long, exhausting 'fourth watch' am I assuming Jesus is absent because the storm has not calmed?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Instead of waiting for your circumstance to change, watch for Jesus in it today, naming one way He is drawing near right now.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You saw the disciples toiling in the dark and came to them across the very sea that fought them -" finish the line in your own words.

The Kingdom of Heaven Is Near You Now

DAY 158

MATTHEW 10:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 323

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:7?

- ② Where have I been treating God as far off or 'someday' while facing today's pressure on my own?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Face one pressing situation today from the truth that the King is 'at hand'; pray into it and let His nearness set your tone.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your kingdom is not far off or someday, but at hand, near me in this very hour -" finish the line in your own words.

The Hard Heart He Still Wants to Heal

DAY 159

MATTHEW 13:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 325

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:15?

- ② What guarded place have I been keeping closed to Jesus out of fear of what He might touch?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Offer Jesus one honest 'yes' today, an unclenched hand toward the very area you have been avoiding, and stay near Him in it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You see the places in me that have gone dull and guarded, and I know now that You name them because You long to heal, not to shame -" finish the line in your own words.

The Voice in the Cloud Names His Son

DAY 160

MARK 9:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 327

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:7?

- ② What competing voices are crowding out the voice of Jesus in my life right now, and what has He already been saying that I have been too busy to hear?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Set aside ten quiet minutes today with no phone and no noise, open one passage where Jesus speaks, and simply listen before you ask Him for anything.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for loving Your Son and for pointing my heart to Him -" finish the line in your own words.

The Prayer Prayed From the Floor

DAY 161

MATTHEW 18:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 329

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:26?

- ② Where have I been trying to compose myself and pay my own way before God, instead of falling down honestly and asking for the mercy I cannot earn?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one specific need or failure you have been hiding, and bring it to God in prayer today in plain words, without excuses or a repayment plan.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I come to You from the floor, with a debt I could never repay and a need I can no longer hide -" finish the line in your own words.

The Tree Is Known by the Fruit It Bears

DAY 162

LUKE 6:43 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 331

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 6:43?

- ② What recurring 'fruit' in my life keeps telling me the truth about a root that still needs healing, and have I been treating the symptom instead of the source?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Pick one habit you keep trying to fix by willpower, and today ask Jesus in prayer to change the desire beneath it rather than just the behavior.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I am tired of managing the outside while the inside stays the same -" finish the line in your own words.

The Boldest Prayer the Brothers Dared to Pray

DAY 163

MARK 10:35 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 333

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:35?

- ② What have I been asking God for lately, and if I am honest, what mixed motives of pride or status are wrapped around that request?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one desire you hold for yourself or your family, lay it before Jesus in prayer today, and ask Him to purify it until His will comes first.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I bring You my boldest requests and the tangled motives behind them -" finish the line in your own words.

The Savior Who Sat Down and Stayed

DAY 164

MATTHEW 15:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 335

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:29?

- ② Where in my life have I confused running myself ragged with truly loving people, and what would change if I sat with Jesus first?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before the demands begin today, take five unhurried minutes simply seated in God's presence - not asking, not doing, just being near Him.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have been running scattered, mistaking exhaustion for love and hurry for faithfulness -" finish the line in your own words.

The Invitation That Runs to the Highways

DAY 165

MATTHEW 22:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 337

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:9?

- ② Have I quietly believed God's invitation is only for a certain kind of person - and where has that kept me, or someone I know, standing off the road instead of at the table?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out today to one person the world tends to overlook - a text, a call, a genuine welcome - and let them feel invited to something good.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your invitation runs all the way to the highways, wide enough to reach even me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man in the Midst of the Lamps

DAY 166

REVELATION 1:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 339

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:13?

- ② In what part of my life have I quietly assumed God is watching from a distance rather than standing right in the midst of it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one lonely or unseen place in your life today and speak to Jesus there directly, as One who is already standing beside you, not far away.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when I feel forgotten and far from You, remind me of John's vision - that You stand in the very midst of Your people, glorious and near at once -" finish the line in your own words.

The Mountain Where Jesus Went to Pray

DAY 167

MARK 6:46 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 341

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:46?

- ② What good and demanding things in my life have quietly crowded out my time alone with God, and what would it cost me to protect that time the way Jesus did?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose a specific time and place today to be alone with God, and guard it - put down the phone, step away from the demands, and pray before anything else claims the hour.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You served the crowds and still climbed the mountain to pray, guarding time alone with the Father -" finish the line in your own words.

One Master, and All of Us Kin

DAY 168

MATTHEW 23:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 343

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 23:8?

- ② Where has my need to be seen as knowledgeable or important turned other believers into rivals or inferiors instead of family?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, honor someone you might normally overlook or feel superior to - ask their opinion, thank them sincerely, or learn something from them as an equal.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You alone are my Master, and everyone around me is my brother and sister -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Day Jesus Overturned the Tables

DAY 169

MARK 11:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 345

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:15?

- ② What 'tables' have quietly been set up in the temple of my heart, crowding out my time of prayer?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one distraction that has overtaken your prayer life and physically remove it for a set time today to make room to be still before God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You entered the temple and overturned all that had robbed it of prayer -" finish the line in your own words.

Three Words From the Sinking Water

DAY 170

MATTHEW 14:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 347

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:30?

- ② What fear tends to pull me under before I think to pray, and what would change if I cried out to Jesus the moment I felt myself starting to sink?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

The next time anxiety rises today, stop and pray three honest words to Jesus right then - 'Lord, save me' - before letting the worry spiral.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, my courage can turn to fear as fast as a gust of wind, and I start to sink before I know it -" finish the line in your own words.

What the Heart Stores, the Mouth Will Spend

DAY 171

LUKE 6:45 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 349

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 6:45?

- ② When my words come out sharp or careless, what do they reveal about what I have been storing in my heart lately?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Instead of only guarding your tongue today, spend a few minutes filling your heart on purpose - read, pray, or give thanks - so that what overflows is worth speaking.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, my words reveal what is really inside me, and sometimes what spills out grieves me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Tree That Withered Overnight

DAY 172

MATTHEW 21:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 351

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:20?

- ② Where in my faith am I keeping up leaves - the appearance of life - while quietly feeling disconnected from the root, which is Christ Himself?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one area of religious activity that has gone hollow, and today reconnect it to real relationship - turn a routine into an honest conversation with God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You see past my leaves to whether there is real life underneath -" finish the line in your own words.

The Questions They Carried Up the Mountain

DAY 173

MARK 13:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 353

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:4?

- ② What honest question about God, my life, or His timing have I been hiding behind a religious face instead of bringing to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one real question you have been afraid to ask God, and bring it to Him in prayer today - plainly, without dressing it up.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have carried questions I was afraid to speak, hiding them behind a composure that looked like faith -" finish the line in your own words.

What He Explains When the Crowd Goes Home

DAY 174

MATTHEW 13:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 355

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:36?

- ② Where have I been settling for encouragement when what I really need is to come closer to Jesus and ask Him for understanding?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one thing you don't understand about your life or your faith into a quiet, unhurried time with God today, and honestly ask Him to make it clear.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have sat through the teaching and still walked away confused, too proud to admit I did not understand -" finish the line in your own words.

A Seat on the Throne He Already Won

DAY 175

REVELATION 3:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 357

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:21?

- ② Where am I trying to overcome in my own strength, or pretending to be untouched, instead of staying near the risen Christ who has already won?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one struggle where you feel like you are losing, and today deliberately hand it to Jesus, resting your hope on His victory rather than your willpower.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, the promise of overcoming feels far above me until I remember You already overcame - through love, through suffering, through the empty grave -" finish the line in your own words.

The Gift He Buried in the Ground

DAY 176

MATTHEW 25:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 359

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:18?

- ② What gift, calling, or dream have I buried out of fear while telling myself I was only being careful?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one small, concrete step today to unbury something you have hidden out of fear - start it, share it, or offer it back to God for His use.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess the ways fear has dressed itself as caution and led me to bury what You entrusted to me -" finish the line in your own words.

Coming Down the Mountain to Live It

DAY 177

MARK 9:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 361

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:9?

- ② Do I only feel close to God in intense spiritual moments, and how faithful am I with Him in the ordinary days that follow?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one thing God has shown or given you recently and, instead of rushing to announce it, quietly obey Him with it today in an ordinary, faithful way.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I love the mountaintop, but You call me to walk with You down into ordinary days too -" finish the line in your own words.

God Is Not Far From the Broken Home

DAY 178

LUKE 20:28 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 363

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 20:28?

- ② What grief or tangled family story have I kept at arm's length as a 'problem to solve' instead of bringing it near to Jesus as a wound to heal?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one real loss or family burden to God in prayer today, naming the people involved, and ask Him to come near to the person inside the pain - including you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I thank You that You are not distant from grief, family pressure, and the stories that did not go the way we hoped -" finish the line in your own words.

The Children Who Cried Hosanna in the Temple

DAY 179

MATTHEW 21:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 365

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:15?

- ② Where might my expectations of how God 'should' work be keeping me from recognizing and rejoicing in the mercy He is actually doing around me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Like the children in the temple, offer God unguarded praise today - out loud, in song or spoken words - without waiting until you feel qualified or everything makes sense.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, keep me from being the one who stands before Your wonders and feels only displeasure -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Calls You Close Before He Sends You Out

DAY 180

MARK 6:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 367

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:7?

- ② Where have I been running into responsibility on my own strength before drawing near to Jesus, and what would change if I let Him call me close first?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one assignment weighing on you today, and before you touch it, spend five quiet minutes with Jesus receiving from Him before you pour out.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for calling me close before You ever send me out -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Knew the Betrayer's Name

DAY 181

MATTHEW 10:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 369

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:4?

- ② What broken trust am I still trying to manage in my own strength, and how would it free me to hand that person over to the Lord who sees truly?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down the name of one person who has let you down, and pray a specific prayer surrendering both them and your wound to Jesus today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are never fooled and never shaken by the hearts around me -"
finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

June in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from June speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 152 • MATTHEW 15:22 + RUTH 2:10

She Cried Out for the One She Loved

A stranger's question, answered again. Ruth asked why grace would notice a foreigner, and Boaz's kindness folded her into David's own family line - centuries later a Canaanite mother calls on that family name, Son of David, and finds the same wide welcome.

DAY 167 • MARK 6:46 + PSALM 55:17

The Mountain Where Jesus Went to Pray

A psalmist's schedule, a Savior's mountain. David kept evening, morning, and noon as appointments God would surely hear, and Jesus dismisses a whole crowd to keep His own appointment on the mountain - prayer that is protected, never leftover.

DAY 181 • MATTHEW 10:4 + 2 KINGS 5:20

The Lord Who Knew the Betrayer's Name

Gehazi's shadow falls on Judas. Elisha's own servant ran after silver and turned grace into a transaction; centuries later another trusted man, close to a greater Master, does the same. Jesus names Judas among the twelve without flinching - He has always known what nearness alone cannot guarantee.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from June keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

JULY

The Cross-Shaped Life

Let surrender make room for resurrection life.

JULY • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

More Than the Prophet of Nazareth

DAY 182

MATTHEW 21:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 371

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:11?

- ② In what parts of my life am I living on borrowed or secondhand faith, and where is Jesus asking to become my own personal Lord?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Speak aloud your own confession of who Jesus is to you today - not what others say, but your own - and let it shape one decision you make.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have known the right words about You while holding You at a distance -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Tells You to Cut It Off

DAY 183

MARK 9:43 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 373

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:43?

- ② What have I made a quiet peace with that Jesus is asking me to cut off, and what keeps me choosing regret over decisive obedience?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one specific access point to harm in your life and take one concrete step today to close it - delete it, block it, confess it, or walk away.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me too much to leave me at peace with what is harming me -"
finish the line in your own words.

When You Run Out of Words, the Spirit Speaks

DAY 184

MATTHEW 10:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 375

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:20?

- ② Where am I relying on my own strength for something only the Spirit can carry, and how would dependence change the way I walk into it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one conversation or task you are dreading, and before it comes, ask the Spirit to speak through you instead of rehearsing your fear.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that when my own words run out, Your Spirit is ready to speak in me -" finish the line in your own words.

Nothing You Leave for the Kingdom Is Ever Lost DAY 185

LUKE 18:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 377

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 18:29?

- ② What have I given up for the sake of following Jesus, and am I letting that sacrifice turn into pride, resentment, or deeper trust?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing obedience has cost you, and instead of counting the loss, thank God today for holding it and recommit to keep following.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that nothing I surrender for Your kingdom is ever lost or forgotten -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Publicans and the Harlots Go In First

DAY 186

MATTHEW 21:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 379

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:31?

- ② Where have I substituted a polished answer for real surrender, and who have I quietly written off that Jesus may be welcoming ahead of me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Turn one yes you have only said with your lips into an act of obedience today, and refuse to look down on someone whose repentance is real.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have offered You a polished answer while my heart stayed unbowed, and forgive me for ranking people by their reputations -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Asks How Many Loaves You Have

DAY 187

MARK 8:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 381

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:5?

- ② When I face a need bigger than my resources, do I tend to panic or to pretend, and what would honest surrender to Jesus look like instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name your actual loaves today - the real time, money, or strength you have - and place that honest count before Jesus, asking Him to multiply it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You can work with what is real -" finish the line in your own words.

He Calls Ordinary People By Name

DAY 188

MATTHEW 10:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 383

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:2?

- ② What about my life makes me feel too ordinary or too unfinished to be used by God, and how does it change things to know He calls me by name?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Say yes to one small assignment or act of witness today that you have been avoiding because you felt too ordinary to be the one to do it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being the God who calls ordinary people by name -" finish the line in your own words.

Come and Take the Water of Life Freely

DAY 189

REVELATION 22:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 385

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:17?

- ② Where am I still trying to earn or repay a grace that God offers freely, and what is my thirst telling me I need to bring straight to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Come to Jesus today with one need you have been trying to fix before bringing it to Him, and simply receive from Him without offering anything in return.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that the water of life is free, offered to whosoever will -" finish the line in your own words.

When Wonder Asks, Is Not This the Son of David?

DAY 190

MATTHEW 12:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 387

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:23?

- ② What honest questions about Jesus am I carrying right now, and am I letting them draw me nearer to Him or drift away before wonder becomes worship?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one real question you have about Jesus directly to Him in prayer today instead of hiding it, and stay in His presence with it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are not afraid of my questions -" finish the line in your own words.

Leaves From Afar, But No Fruit Up Close

DAY 191

MARK 11:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 389

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:13?

- ② Where in my life am I producing leaves - the appearance of faith - without the real fruit that only shows up close, and what roots need feeding?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Invite Jesus to examine one area where your outward faith outruns your inward reality, and take one honest step toward real fruit today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You come near enough to see the truth about me -" finish the line in your own words.

No Root, No Standing When the Sun Comes Up

DAY 192

MATTHEW 13:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 391

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:6?

- ② Am I mistaking quick spiritual emotion for deep-rooted trust, and where is the current heat in my life revealing what my roots have not yet held?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one hidden, unglamorous practice - prayer, Scripture, or confession - and commit to it this week to let Jesus grow your roots deeper.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for caring more about my roots than my quick growth -" finish the line in your own words.

Awake in the Days of Noah

DAY 193

LUKE 17:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 393

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 17:26?

- ② Where have I been sleepwalking through ordinary life without walking with God, and what would holy attention look like in my daily routine?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Pick one ordinary task today - a meal, a commute, a chore - and do it consciously in Jesus' presence, talking with Him through it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for calling me awake in the middle of my ordinary days -" finish the line in your own words.

When False Christs Show Signs and Wonders

DAY 194

MARK 13:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 395

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:22?

- ② Where am I tempted to chase spiritual spectacle or convincing voices instead of resting close to the Christ I already know?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Spend time in Scripture today deliberately learning Jesus' true voice, so you can more easily recognize what does not sound like Him.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for warning me plainly and keeping me safely -" finish the line in your own words.

I Was the Stranger You Did Not Take In

DAY 195

MATTHEW 25:43 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 397

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:43?

- ② Whose need have I felt compassion for but never actually moved toward, and what has kept my mercy a feeling instead of an action?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one concrete step of costly mercy today - a call, a meal, a visit, or a note - toward someone others overlook.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for meeting me in the faces of the overlooked -" finish the line in your own words.

The Enemy Sows While Men Sleep

DAY 196

MATTHEW 13:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 399

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:25?

- ② What trouble has sprung up in my life that I did not plant, and am I responding with denial, with panic, or with watchful trust in the Master of the field?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one situation you have been either ignoring or frantically trying to control, and choose one steady, faithful step while trusting Jesus with the harvest.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that even when trouble is sown in my field, You have never lost control of it -" finish the line in your own words.

None Is Good But God Alone

DAY 197

MARK 10:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 401

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:18?

- ② Is my obedience aimed at pleasing God or at feeling impressive, and where have I been measuring my goodness by my own reflection instead of His grace?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one good thing today in secret, where no one but God will see it, to reorder your goodness toward Him rather than your reputation.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me too much to let my goodness become about me -" finish the line in your own words.

Forgive Until Seventy Times Seven

DAY 198

MATTHEW 18:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 403

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:22?

- ② What record of wrongs am I still keeping, and how is holding that ledger quietly ruling my inner life instead of Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one person you have been keeping score against, and take one step today to release the ledger to Jesus - in prayer, a word, or an act of mercy.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for tearing up the ledger I keep so carefully -" finish the line in your own words.

Love God With Every Part of You

DAY 199

LUKE 10:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 405

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 10:27?

- ② Which part of me - heart, soul, strength, or mind - am I holding back from loving God, and where has my devotion become divided?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one area you usually keep separate from God - your thoughts, your schedule, or a relationship - under His love today, and make one decision that helps you love Him with more of yourself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for calling me to love You with my whole self - heart, soul, strength, and mind -" finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Pays the Last the Same as the First

DAY 200

MATTHEW 20:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 407

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:14?

- ② Where have I been measuring God's goodness by comparing my portion to someone else's, and what would it look like to receive what He has given me as truly enough?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, name one person God has clearly blessed and thank Him for it out loud, refusing to let envy narrate the moment.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for being a God who keeps every promise and gives beyond what I deserve -" finish the line in your own words.

Jesus Names Everything You Left for His Sake

DAY 201

MARK 10:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 409

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:29?

- ② What have I left - or am I being asked to leave - for the sake of Jesus, and do I truly believe He has noticed and holds it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, open your hands in prayer over one thing you fear releasing, and speak a simple word of surrender before the day fills up.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for seeing every cost I have paid to follow You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Midnight Cry That Wakes the Waiting Heart DAY 202

MATTHEW 25:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 411

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:6?

- ② Where has my spiritual expectancy quietly fallen asleep, and what 'midnight cry' might God be using to wake my heart back to attention?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, do one thing that keeps your lamp trimmed - an unhurried time of prayer, or a return to a promise you had stopped believing.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being the Bridegroom who comes for His own -" finish the line in your own words.

The River of Life Flowing from the Throne of the Lamb

DAY 203

REVELATION 22:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 413

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:1?

- ② In what dry place am I walking right now, and how does knowing where the road ends - at the river from the throne - change the way I carry it today?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, bring one specific thirst of your soul to Jesus in prayer and ask Him for a fresh drink of His living water.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, Lamb upon the throne, thank You that the end of the road is not dryness but a river of life -" finish the line in your own words.

The Life You Clutch Slips Away; the Life You Surrender Is Found

DAY 204

MATTHEW 10:39 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 415

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:39?

- ② What am I clutching so tightly that it has begun to wear me down, and have I been calling that grip 'wisdom' or 'responsibility' to avoid surrendering it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, open your hands in prayer and name one thing you are releasing into Christ's keeping.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the holy paradox of Your kingdom, where losing my life for Your sake is how I truly find it -" finish the line in your own words.

The Man Who Came Close, Then Walked Away Grieved

DAY 205

MARK 10:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 417

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:22?

- ② What is the one thing I would grieve to lose more than I would grieve to disobey Jesus, and what does that reveal about who owns my heart?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, loosen your grip on one possession or comfort by giving something away or offering it back to God in prayer.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to name what owns my heart -" finish the line in your own words.

Lay a Blessing at the Door Before You Offer Any Proof

DAY 206

MATTHEW 10:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 419

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:12?

- ② What room, relationship, or conversation am I bracing for defensively, and how would it change if I entered it carrying a blessing instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, deliberately open one interaction with a word of peace or genuine kindness before addressing anything difficult.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for sending Your people with peace on their lips before power in their hands -" finish the line in your own words.

What Self-Preservation Can Never Save

DAY 207

MARK 8:35 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 421

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:35?

- ② Where has self-protection quietly become the master I obey, and what obedience have I avoided because it felt too costly to my safety?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, take one small step of obedience you have been putting off out of fear, trusting Christ with the outcome.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for saving what I could never save on my own -" finish the line in your own words.

Immediately Jesus Stretched Forth His Hand

DAY 208

MATTHEW 14:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 423

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:31?

- ② Where do I feel myself sinking right now, and do I believe Jesus reaches to catch me immediately - before I have proven myself or calmed the storm?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, cry out to Jesus in one specific 'sinking' moment instead of trying to save yourself first.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for reaching out immediately when I begin to sink -" finish the line in your own words.

Ready for the Hour You Do Not Expect

DAY 209

LUKE 12:40 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 425

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:40?

- ② Am I facing the future more like a drowsy sleeper or an anxious striver, and what would 'readiness that rests' look like for me today?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, make one 'next faithful choice' you have been delaying - a forgiveness, a prayer, an act of obedience - while there is still time.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You hold the hour I cannot see -" finish the line in your own words.

The Boat That Bowed Down and Worshiped

DAY 210

MATTHEW 14:33 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 427

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:33?

- ② What recent rescue or answered prayer have I moved past without truly stopping to worship Jesus for it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, take a few unhurried minutes to worship Jesus for one storm He has carried you through.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for carrying me through storms I could not control and for showing me who You truly are -" finish the line in your own words.

The Call to Deny Yourself and Follow

DAY 211

MARK 8:34 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 429

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:34?

- ② In what area of my life am I still sitting on the throne, and what would it look like to step down and let Jesus truly lead there?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, hand one specific decision or worry over to Jesus' leadership instead of managing it yourself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for calling me to follow You honestly, without flattery -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Walks into Unfamiliar Country

DAY 212

MATTHEW 15:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 431

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:21?

- ② What unfamiliar or unchosen place am I standing in right now, and how does it change things to believe Jesus is fully Lord of even that ground?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, name the 'unmapped' area of your life to God and ask Him to show you the mercy He has already placed there.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You walk into the very places I would never have chosen -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

July in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from July speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 182 • MATTHEW 21:11 + DEUTERONOMY 18:15

More Than the Prophet of Nazareth

Moses promised; Nazareth delivered. Moses told Israel that God would raise up a Prophet from among their brethren - 'unto him ye shall hearken.' The crowd's answer names the Prophet correctly; obedience is what finishes the sentence.

DAY 197 • MARK 10:18 + PSALM 119:68

None Is Good But God Alone

Goodness has one address. The rich ruler tossed "good" around like a compliment; the psalmist had already learned where goodness lives - Thou art good, and doest good; teach me thy statutes. Right obedience starts by looking at the good God, not at our own reflection.

DAY 212 • MATTHEW 15:21 + 1 KINGS 17:9

The Lord Who Walks into Unfamiliar Country

Zarephath knew this road already. Long before, God sent Elijah into Sidon's country where a widow was already appointed to meet him; when Jesus walks those same coasts, mercy is again out ahead of Him. Unfamiliar ground is still assigned ground.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from July keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

AUGUST

Serving in His Steps

Practice the humility of Jesus in hidden and public service.

AUGUST • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Righteous Who Could Not Remember Keeping Score DAY 213

MATTHEW 25:37 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 433

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:37?

- ② Where have I been quietly keeping score of my service, and how would my giving change if I truly served without needing to be seen?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, do one act of kindness in secret that no one but God will ever know about.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for forming servants who give without keeping score -" finish the line in your own words.

How Jesus Reads a Hungry Man's Need

DAY 214

MARK 2:25 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 435

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 2:25?

- ② Where has my instinct been to accuse or 'be right' rather than to see a person's real need with mercy?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, when you notice yourself judging someone's struggle, pause and ask what mercy would see instead - then act on it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for reading human need with mercy instead of suspicion -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Seated Until His Enemies Become His Footstool DAY 215

MATTHEW 22:44 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 437

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:44?

- ② What am I striving to control right now, and how does it change my grip to remember that Christ is already seated in authority over it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, name one outcome you keep grabbing at, hand it to the reigning Christ in prayer, and then take your hands off it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for reigning at the Father's right hand while every enemy is brought beneath Your feet -" finish the line in your own words.

The Holy Moment Peter Tried to Build

DAY 216

LUKE 9:33 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 439

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:33?

- ② When God draws near, do I tend to receive the moment or rush to manage it, and why does stillness feel so vulnerable to me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, sit in silence with God for a few minutes without filling it with words or tasks - simply behold Him.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the holy moments when You draw near -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son Who Is Also David's Lord

DAY 217

MATTHEW 22:45 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 441

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:45?

- ② Have I quietly made Jesus small enough to control, and what fear am I carrying that a bigger view of His lordship would put to rest?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, bring one fear you have been managing on your own to Jesus, deliberately naming Him as Lord over it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for shrinking You down to what feels familiar and manageable -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man Who Came to Serve and Pay the Ransom DAY 218

MARK 10:45 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 443

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:45?

- ② What kind of service have I quietly considered beneath me, and how does the Son of Man laying down His life reshape what greatness means for me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, serve one person who cannot repay you, in a way no one will reward or even notice.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for coming not to be served but to serve, and for giving Your life a ransom to set me free -" finish the line in your own words.

The Coin in the Fish's Mouth

DAY 219

MATTHEW 17:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 445

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:27?

- ② Where am I tempted to prove a point or insist on a right I truly have, and is love asking me to yield instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, deliberately choose the peaceable path in one situation where you could have won the argument.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being so free and yet so gentle, paying a tax You did not owe rather than needlessly tripping others up -" finish the line in your own words.

The Savior Who Turns and Asks the Question

DAY 220

MATTHEW 22:41 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 447

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:41?

- ② What question do I sense Jesus asking beneath my hurry and my need to explain myself, and what am I afraid it will uncover?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Sit quietly for ten minutes today and let Jesus ask who you truly believe He is - then write your honest answer.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus does not corner me but turns toward me with a question that opens my heart -" finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man Coming in the Clouds

DAY 221

MARK 13:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 449

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:26?

- ② Where am I living as if the story might end in defeat, and how would today look different if I truly believed the Son of Man is coming in glory?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one injustice or unresolved wrong you are carrying, and hand it to Jesus in prayer as something His return will surely settle.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus is coming again in power and glory, and that history is not drifting but moving toward Him -" finish the line in your own words.

The King Who Says All Things Are Ready

DAY 222

MATTHEW 22:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 451

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:4?

- ② What am I waiting to 'fix' about myself before I believe I am welcome at God's table, and where did that lie come from?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Accept the invitation today exactly as you are - and pass it on by inviting one person you would not normally include.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for a King who prepares the feast Himself and sends word that all things are ready -" finish the line in your own words.

The One Master Worthy of Your Soul

DAY 223

MATTHEW 23:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 453

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 23:10?

- ② Whose voice has been sitting on the throne of my formation lately, and what would change if I gave that place back to Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one opinion or critic you have been ruled by, and consciously release it to Jesus as your only Master today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus is my one Master, the Guide who leads my soul all the way home -" finish the line in your own words.

The Wisdom That Left Them Marveling

DAY 224

MARK 12:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 455

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:17?

- ② Where has pressure been making me sharp or reactive, and what would it look like to answer from Christ's wisdom instead of from fear?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

The next time you feel baited today, pause before answering, and silently give yourself back to God before you speak.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus meets every trap with wisdom that cannot be bent to serve a scheme -" finish the line in your own words.

The Road We Build by Laying Things Down

DAY 225

MATTHEW 21:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 457

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:8?

- ② What am I gripping that I have been unwilling to lay down before Jesus, even while I gladly praise Him in the crowd?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one specific thing - a control, a comfort, a need to be noticed - and surrender it to Christ in a concrete act today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus is a King worthy of everything I own -" finish the line in your own words.

The Promise That Says Surely I Come Quickly

DAY 226

REVELATION 22:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 459

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:20?

- ② What have I been waiting on so long that hope feels heavy, and how does 'surely I come quickly' change the way I carry it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Whisper 'Even so, come, Lord Jesus' over one specific ache today, and let it be your prayer each time weariness rises.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Scripture closes not with my effort but with the promise of Jesus: surely I come quickly -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Savior Answers Not a Word

DAY 227

MATTHEW 15:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 461

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:23?

- ② Where has God's silence tempted me to believe He is rejecting me, and how might it instead be an invitation to keep seeking Him?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Return today to one prayer you had almost given up on, and bring it to Jesus again - out loud if you can.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the silence of Jesus is never the same as His rejection -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Savior Who Notices You Have Nothing to Eat DAY 228

MARK 8:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 463

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:1?

- ② What need - hunger, grief, or weariness - have I been minimizing as if faithfulness meant ignoring it, and what is Jesus inviting me to bring Him?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one real limit today and honor it as Jesus would - rest, eat, or ask for help instead of pushing through.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus notices empty stomachs and tired bodies and does not despise human weakness -" finish the line in your own words.

The King Whose Coming Shakes the City

DAY 229

MATTHEW 21:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 465

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:10?

- ② Where have I grown so familiar with faith that I assume Jesus rather than truly seek Him, and what would honestly asking 'Who is this?' stir up in me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Spend time today learning something true about who Jesus is from the Gospels, and let it challenge one comfortable assumption you have held.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the coming of Jesus shakes cities and hearts awake -" finish the line in your own words.

The Hands That Take the Little and Bless It

DAY 230

LUKE 9:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 467

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:16?

- ② What small offering have I been withholding because it feels too insignificant, and what might Jesus do if I placed it in His hands?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Give the 'little' you have been holding back today - the prayer, the gift, the ordinary act - without waiting until it feels like enough.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus does not despise a small offering but takes it, blesses it, breaks it, and makes it enough -" finish the line in your own words.

The Master Fear Wrongly Called Hard

DAY 231

MATTHEW 25:24 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 469

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:24?

- ② Where has fear painted God as harsh or demanding in my mind, and how might drawing closer to Jesus correct that picture?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'talent' or assignment you have buried out of fear, and take one step of obedience with it today, trusting God's goodness.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that You are not the hard master my fear invents from a distance -" finish the line in your own words.

When They Called His Light Darkness

DAY 232

MARK 3:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 471

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:22?

- ② Where has suspicion or cynicism led me to misname something good that God may actually be doing?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one situation you have been reading with suspicion, and ask Jesus to show you His hand in it before you judge it today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the power of Jesus sets people free, even when threatened hearts call it something else -" finish the line in your own words.

The Quiet Work That Fulfills the Promise

DAY 233

MATTHEW 12:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 473

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:17?

- ② Where have I been believing my quiet faithfulness does not matter because it doesn't look impressive, and how does God's hidden purpose change that?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one act of hidden, unrewarded obedience today on purpose, trusting God to weave it into something bigger than you can see.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the quiet work of Jesus was never random but fulfilled the promises You made long before -" finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Promises What Is Right

DAY 234

MATTHEW 20:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 475

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:4?

- ② What obedience have I been delaying until God explains the outcome, and what would it look like to go on the strength of His righteous character?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Say yes to one thing God is clearly asking of you today without demanding to know how it will turn out.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus is righteous in everything He assigns, and that His promise to give what is right is better than any guarantee I could demand -" finish the line in your own words.

The Word That Restores a Withered Hand

DAY 235

MARK 3:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 477

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:5?

- ② What withered place have I been hiding from Jesus, and what would it mean to 'stretch it out' into His hands today?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one hidden struggle into the light today - name it honestly to Jesus, and if you can, to one trusted person.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus calls my withered places into the open and restores them whole -" finish the line in your own words.

The Table Filled from the Highways

DAY 236

MATTHEW 22:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 479

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:10?

- ② Who have I quietly decided is too far gone for God's grace, and how does remembering that I was gathered by grace change how I see them?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Extend genuine welcome today to someone outside your usual circle - an invitation, not a verdict.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Your servants gathered both bad and good until the wedding hall was full, and that Your welcome reached even me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Faith That Trusts Even the Crumbs

DAY 237

MATTHEW 15:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 481

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:27?

- ② Have I stopped asking God for something because I feel unworthy, and what would humble, confident faith do instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one need back to Jesus today with the mother's posture - no arguing your worth, just trusting His mercy.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that even the crumbs of Your mercy are more than enough for my deepest need -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Walks the Fields with the Hungry DAY 238

MARK 2:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 483

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 2:23?

- ② Where has the fear of being misunderstood or criticized made me anxious, and how does knowing Jesus stands with me change it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one honest step of obedience today that you have been avoiding out of fear of others' judgment, trusting Jesus' verdict over theirs.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus walks with His people even when they are misunderstood, and that He is not intimidated by accusing eyes -" finish the line in your own words.

The Least Seed That Becomes a Shelter

DAY 239

MATTHEW 13:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 485

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:32?

- ② What small, slow-growing thing am I tempted to give up on, and how does the mustard seed change the way I see it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Tend one 'small seed' today - a habit, a relationship, a hope - with patience instead of demanding immediate results.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus turns the least of all seeds into a tree wide enough to shelter -" finish the line in your own words.

There Is Mercy Even for the Word You Spoke Against Him

DAY 240

LUKE 12:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 487

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:10?

- ② What word or memory have I been carrying as unforgivable, and what would change if I truly believed Jesus' promise that it can be forgiven?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name that heavy word to God out loud in prayer today, and receive His forgiveness instead of rehearsing the shame.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Your mercy is wider than my worst words -" finish the line in your own words.

The Father Was Well Pleased Before the Work Began

DAY 241

MATTHEW 12:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 489

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:18?

- ② Where in my life am I still working to earn a love and approval that God says are already mine in Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before you do anything productive today, sit quietly and receive the Father's words over you: beloved, chosen, well pleased.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for calling me beloved before I have done a single thing to earn it -" finish the line in your own words.

He Exposed the World's Grip on Power

DAY 242

MARK 10:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 491

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:42?

- ② Where am I holding onto control out of fear, and what would it look like to lead there with humility instead of domination?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one relationship where you have been pressing your will down, and choose today to serve that person instead of controlling them.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You saw how the world grasps for power, and You called me to a different way -"
finish the line in your own words.

Mercy Refused Grieves the Whole Household

DAY 243

MATTHEW 18:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 493

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:31?

- ② What offense have I been treating as a private grudge, and how might it be quietly affecting the people around me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one specific resentment to God today in honest prayer, and ask Him to begin softening your heart toward that person.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, thank You for loving me enough to tell me the truth -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

August in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from August speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 213 • MATTHEW 25:37 + 1 CHRONICLES 29:14

The Righteous Who Could Not Remember Keeping Score

Surprised givers in both Testaments. David marveled that anything offered to God was God's own already - of thine own have we given thee. The righteous in Jesus' parable share that astonishment: mercy done so freely it never counted itself.

DAY 228 • MARK 8:1 + MATTHEW 15:32

The Savior Who Notices You Have Nothing to Eat

He says the word Himself: compassion. Matthew lets us hear what Mark's scene holds: "I have compassion on the multitude... I will not send them away fasting." The Lord who counts your three days of staying near also counts the miles home - He will not let you faint on the way.

DAY 243 • MATTHEW 18:31 + PSALM 119:136

Mercy Refused Grieves the Whole Household

Rivers of tears over unkept mercy. The psalmist's eyes run like rivers "because they keep not thy law" - grief over another's hardness, carried straight to God. The fellowservants do the same with the unmerciful servant: a sorrow that refuses to gossip and goes to the lord instead.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from August keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

SEPTEMBER

Courage to Witness

Carry the truth of Jesus with courage and gentleness.

SEPTEMBER • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

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WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

☐ Matthew

☐ Luke

☐ Mark

☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

Strength That Never Needs to Shout

DAY 244

MATTHEW 12:19 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 495

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:19?

- ② Where have I been mistaking loudness for strength, or harshness for truth, in the way I speak to others?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

In your next tense conversation, choose to lower your voice and speak the truth gently instead of trying to win by force.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for showing me a strength that does not need to shout -" finish the line in your own words.

It Is I; Be Not Afraid

DAY 245

MARK 6:50 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 497

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:50?

- ② What fear has become the loudest voice interpreting my life right now, and what is Jesus saying over that storm?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

When anxiety rises today, pause and speak His words back to yourself: 'Be of good cheer; it is He; be not afraid.'

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when the storm is loud and fear becomes the only voice I hear, come near and speak -" finish the line in your own words.

You Outweigh a Thousand Sparrows

DAY 246

MATTHEW 10:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 499

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:31?

- ② In what area have I let fear convince me that I am small or overlooked, and how does the Father's estimate of my worth challenge that lie?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one step today - a word, a prayer, an act of faith - that you have been avoiding out of fear, trusting that the Father sees you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, thank You that I am worth more to You than many sparrows -" finish the line in your own words.

Not One Sparrow Is Forgotten

DAY 247

LUKE 12:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 501

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:6?

- ② What small worry or ache have I been withholding from God because it felt too insignificant to bring Him?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Pray today about one 'too small' concern, trusting that the God who remembers sparrows remembers it too.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, thank You that not one sparrow is forgotten before You - and neither am I -" finish the line in your own words.

When He Stepped In, the Wind Gave Out

DAY 248

MATTHEW 14:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 503

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:32?

- ② Do I tend to seek a method for my storms more than the nearness of Jesus, and how might I welcome His presence instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

After the next thing settles in your life, resist rushing on - linger with Jesus in prayer and thank Him instead of self-protecting.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your presence is the answer I keep trying to engineer -" finish the line in your own words.

Dragged Before Kings, It Becomes a Testimony

DAY 249

MARK 13:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 505

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:9?

- ② What intimidating setting am I dreading, and how might Jesus be preparing to make my life a testimony even there?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Ask God today for gentle courage to speak or live out one true thing about Jesus in a setting that usually silences you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You walked the hard road before me and You see testimony where I see only threat -" finish the line in your own words.

He Bore Record of What He Saw

DAY 250

REVELATION 1:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 507

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:2?

- ② Has my faith been more of a private secret or a witness others can see, and what has kept me from bearing record of what I have seen of Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Tell one person today something true and specific about what you have seen God do in your life.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for all I have seen of Your goodness -" finish the line in your own words.

This Gospel Will Reach Every Nation

DAY 251

MATTHEW 24:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 509

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 24:14?

- ② Have I been treating the gospel mainly as private comfort, and where is Jesus sending me to carry it into ordinary places?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one ordinary setting - home, work, or a friendship - and look for a natural way to let the good news show there today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for a gospel too big to keep in my pocket -" finish the line in your own words.

Welcome the One He Sends, and You Welcome Him

DAY 252

MATTHEW 10:40 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 511

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:40?

- ② Who have I been treating as an interruption rather than as someone Jesus may be sending my way?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Give one person your full, unhurried attention today, receiving them as though you were welcoming Christ Himself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have treated people as interruptions instead of welcoming You in them -" finish the line in your own words.

God Speaks in the Present Tense at the Bush

DAY 253

MARK 12:26 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 513

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:26?

- ② What situation have I marked as 'final,' and what might change if I let God's living 'I am' speak into it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one Scripture promise to a place in your life that feels closed today, and pray it back to God as present truth.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Living God, thank You that You speak of Your people in the present tense - 'I am,' not 'I was.' When grief insists the story is over, bring Your Word into my dead-end... -" finish the line in your own words.

They Watched Grace Save Sinners and Still Would Not Turn

DAY 254

MATTHEW 21:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 515

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:32?

- ② Has grace reaching someone unexpected ever stirred pride in me instead of joy, and what does that reveal about my own heart?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Thank God today for one person whose changed life you have witnessed, and ask Him to soften any corner of your heart you have refused to surrender.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, guard me from a pride so subtle it can watch You change lives and stay unmoved -"
finish the line in your own words.

Your Own Sons Will Judge Your Uneven Scales

DAY 255

LUKE 11:19 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 517

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:19?

- ② Where have I been measuring others by a standard I quietly excuse in myself?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Catch yourself in one critical judgment today and ask honestly whether you hold yourself to the same measure.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You see how easily I judge in others what I excuse in myself—" finish the line in your own words.

He Set a Child in the Middle of Their Ambition

DAY 256

MATTHEW 18:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 519

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:2?

- ② In what ways am I still proving, posing, or competing to feel that I matter, instead of resting as God's child?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Let go of one bid for status or recognition today, and practice simply belonging to God without earning it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You answered the scramble for greatness by setting a little child in the middle -"
finish the line in your own words.

He Had One Son Left, and He Sent Him

DAY 257

MARK 12:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 521

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:6?

- ② Have I been substituting busyness or service for actually receiving and beholding Jesus, and where is my heart still guarded toward Him?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Set aside time today simply to behold Jesus in prayer or Scripture, receiving Him before doing anything for Him.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Father, thank You for holding nothing back - for sending Your wellbeloved Son as Your fullest appeal to me -" finish the line in your own words.

He Gave Them One Clear Road, Not the Whole World

DAY 258

MATTHEW 10:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 523

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:5?

- ② What burdens am I carrying that Jesus never actually assigned to me, and what is the one clear step He is giving me right now?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name the single next assignment God has clearly given you, and give yourself permission today to lay down what He has not.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You give a focused path, not a crushing burden -" finish the line in your own words.

There Shall Be No Night There

DAY 259

REVELATION 22:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 525

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:5?

- ② Have I started to wear a long struggle as my identity, and how does the promise that God will be my everlasting light change how I see this season?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one faithful step today in the light you already have, refusing to let the darkness define who you are.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord God, thank You that a day is coming with no night at all, when You Yourself will be my everlasting light -" finish the line in your own words.

The Savior Who Stood Still to Call You

DAY 260

MARK 10:49 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 527

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:49?

- ② What need have I been hiding because I assumed I was too small to stop anyone - and what would it look like to bring it honestly to Jesus, who is already standing still for me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name the one need you have been swallowing and speak it out loud to God today - no performing, no minimizing - simply telling Him plainly what mercy you need.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for being the Savior who stops for the ones the world hurries past -" finish the line in your own words.

The Faithful One God Never Left in the Dark

DAY 261

MATTHEW 14:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 529

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:10?

- ② Where has faithfulness cost me something the world never noticed, and can I trust that God saw every moment of it even when heaven felt silent?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one honest grief to God today without dressing it up - write it out or speak it plainly - and ask Him to hold it with you instead of carrying it alone.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for being near even when the faithful road turns painful -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Whose Authority No One Had to Approve

DAY 262

LUKE 20:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 531

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 20:2?

- ② Whose approval have I been waiting for before I fully obey God, and what would change if I trusted that His authority over my life is already enough?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one step of obedience today that you have been delaying until someone else approved of it - act on what God has already made clear.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Your authority never depended on anyone's approval -"
finish the line in your own words.

Sent as Sheep Among Wolves

DAY 263

MATTHEW 10:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 533

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:16?

- ② Where has a hard place tempted me to trade my tenderness for toughness, and how can I ask Jesus for both wisdom and innocence instead of choosing one?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one 'wolf' situation you are facing and take a wise, discerning step today without letting it harden your heart - stay shrewd and stay kind.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for sending me out with both wisdom and innocence -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Is Still Lord When He Withdraws DAY 264

MARK 3:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 535

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:7?

- ② Where have I confused being constantly busy and visible with being faithful, and is God inviting me to step back and make room to breathe?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one arena where you have been overextending to prove yourself and deliberately step back today, trusting God to keep holding what you release.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus was Lord even when He withdrew -" finish the line in your own words.

The Whisper Meant for the Rooftop

DAY 265

MATTHEW 10:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 537

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:27?

- ② What has Jesus made clear to me in the hidden place that fear has kept me from saying out loud, and who might need to hear it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Speak one truth God has given you to a single person today - no performance, just honest witness to what He has done in your life.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for the truth You speak into my heart in the hidden place -" finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Tells a Story to Reach the Heart

DAY 266

MATTHEW 22:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 539

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:1?

- ② What truth have I been keeping at arm's length with excuses and deflection, and what might change if I let Jesus' light reach it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Sit quietly and ask God to show you one thing you have been defending; when He reveals it, write it down instead of explaining it away.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus reaches my heart with such patience and love -" finish the line in your own words.

The Small Errand Inside the Holy Story

DAY 267

MARK 11:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 541

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:1?

- ② What ordinary task in front of me have I been despising as too small to matter, and how might God be weaving it into a bigger story?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do the next small, unglamorous task God has clearly put before you today as an act of faithful obedience, without waiting for a bigger moment.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that no small obedience is ever wasted in Your hands -" finish the line in your own words.

Sent to the Lost Sheep by Name

DAY 268

MATTHEW 10:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 543

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:6?

- ② Where have I been trying to carry a need God never assigned to me, and what would it look like to ask Him instead where He is actually sending me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Ask God to show you the one or two specific people He is sending you to right now, and give your attention to them today instead of the whole overwhelming world.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that You send with wisdom and never ask me to carry the whole world alone -" finish the line in your own words.

The Last Word Is Grace

DAY 269

REVELATION 22:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 545

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:21?

- ② Where am I still striving to earn a love and a place that God has already given me by grace, and what would it feel like to finally rest?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing you have been trying to earn from God today, and deliberately receive it as a gift instead - thank Him for grace you could never work for.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the last word over my life is grace -" finish the line in your own words.

Shake the Dust and Keep Walking

DAY 270

LUKE 9:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 547

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:5?

- ② What rejection have I been carrying around as if it defines me, and what would change if I truly shook the dust free and kept walking?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'no' or closed door you have been replaying, release it to God today, and take one forward step toward what He still has in front of you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that rejection never gets to define who I am -" finish the line in your own words.

The Man Who Knelt at the Foot of the Mountain

DAY 271

MATTHEW 17:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 549

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:14?

- ② What burden have I been managing and dressing up instead of honestly bringing to Jesus, and what is keeping me from kneeling with it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one real need to God on your knees today - literally or in your heart - without minimizing it or managing your appearance before Him.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus came down the mountain to meet real, kneeling need -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Welcomes the Honest Question

DAY 272

MARK 9:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 551

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:11?

- ② What honest question or doubt have I been afraid to bring to God, and what might He teach me if I finally drew near and asked it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one real question you have been swallowing to God in prayer today, and open the Scripture or ask a trusted believer to help you seek His answer.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus welcomes honest questions instead of shaming them -"
finish the line in your own words.

Sent Without Gold in the Purse

DAY 273

MATTHEW 10:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 553

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:9?

- ② What has God made clear that I keep postponing until I feel more resourced or in control, and where is anxious accumulation quietly replacing trust?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one step of obedience today that you have been delaying until conditions felt safer, and trust God to supply what you cannot secure yourself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Your calling never depends on the size of my reserves -"
finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

September in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from September speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 244 • MATTHEW 12:19 + 2 TIMOTHY 2:24

Strength That Never Needs to Shout

The Servant's manner, every servant's rule. Isaiah's Servant "shall not strive, nor cry," and Paul turns it into a standing order: "the servant of the Lord must not strive; but be gentle unto all men." Quiet strength is not a personality type - it is the family resemblance.

DAY 259 • REVELATION 22:5 + MICAH 7:8

There Shall Be No Night There

Darkness is only a sitting place. Micah answers his enemy from the ground: when I sit in darkness, the LORD shall be a light unto me. Revelation finishes his sentence - a city with no night at all, where God Himself is the lamp forever.

DAY 273 • MATTHEW 10:9 + LUKE 22:35

Sent Without Gold in the Purse

The empty purse lacked nothing. Years later Jesus audits these very orders: 'When I sent you without purse... lacked ye any thing?' Their answer - 'Nothing' - is the testimony that obedience never had to wait on a full wallet.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from September keeps returning to you, and why?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

OCTOBER

Life Together in Christ

Let forgiveness and peace shape the people around the table.

OCTOBER • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ 1 Peter

- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Quiet No That Still Declines a King

DAY 274

MATTHEW 22:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 555

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:5?

- ② What good and ordinary things have quietly crowded God's invitation out of first place in my life, and what am I really saying no to when I do?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before the busyness of the day claims you, sit at God's table first today - give Him your first and best attention rather than the leftovers.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for inviting me to Your table even when my life is crowded with good things -" finish the line in your own words.

The Stronger One Who Binds the Captor

DAY 275

MARK 3:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 557

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 3:27?

- ② What have I been trying to break free from in my own strength, and what would change if I trusted Jesus as the Stronger One to fight that battle?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name the one stronghold that has held you longest and hand it over to Jesus in prayer today, asking the Stronger One to do what your effort never could.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus is stronger than everything that has ever bound me -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Savior Who Meets Us in the Ordinary Bill

DAY 276

MATTHEW 17:24 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 559

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:24?

- ② Which ordinary, practical pressures do I handle with more anxiety than the big crises, and what would change if I invited Jesus into those everyday details?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one mundane obligation you have been carrying anxiously - a bill, a form, a pressing question - and pray over it today, deliberately inviting Jesus into it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that Jesus meets me in the ordinary bills and practical questions of everyday life, not only in the dramatic moments -" finish the line in your own words.

The Watchful Household of the Faithful

DAY 277

LUKE 12:39 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 561

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:39?

- ② Am I drifting into spiritual sleepiness or worn out by anxious over-guarding, and how is Jesus inviting me into watchful peace instead of either extreme?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Tend one 'lamp' today that you have let grow dim - prayer, Scripture, or an act of faithfulness - doing it from settled trust rather than fear or obligation.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You for calling me to alert faithfulness instead of either sleepy drifting or anxious dread -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Draws Back the Curtain

DAY 278

REVELATION 1:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 563

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:1?

- ② Where am I straining to figure out the whole future instead of trusting the Christ who reveals Himself, and what step of obedience is the light already showing me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one unknown that is stirring anxiety in you and deliberately hand it to Jesus today, choosing to take the next step of obedience with the light He has already given.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that You do not leave Your people guessing in the dark -" finish the line in your own words.

The Resurrection Too Large for Our Categories

DAY 279

MATTHEW 22:28 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 565

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:28?

- ② Where am I refusing to trust God because His promise will not fit inside my understanding, and what would it look like to let Him be larger than my categories?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one worry where you are trying to control tomorrow with yesterday's fear, and surrender it to God today, choosing to trust His greatness over your need to understand.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that You are always larger than the frames I try to fit You into -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Savior Who Sees Through Every Mask

DAY 280

MARK 12:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 567

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:15?

- ② Where in my life right now am I being pulled into someone's game - and am I responding from the peace of Christ or from panic, resentment, and the need to win?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one relationship where flattery or manipulation has unsettled you, and today ask Jesus for discernment before you respond, choosing a clear-eyed answer that stays gentle.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You who knew the hypocrisy in that temple court, give me eyes that see clearly and a heart that stays tender -" finish the line in your own words.

When Peter Tried to Count Forgiveness

DAY 281

MATTHEW 18:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 569

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:21?

- ② Whose offense am I still counting, and what would change in me if I stopped guarding the tally and brought that wound honestly to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one person you have been keeping score against, and today take one concrete step of release - a prayer, a kind word, a loosened grip - even before the feeling of forgiveness arrives.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I am tired of keeping score -" finish the line in your own words.

Jesus Beheld Him and Loved Him

DAY 282

MARK 10:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 571

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:21?

- ② What is the one thing I am holding so tightly that I cannot walk freely with Jesus - money, reputation, control, comfort, or an old identity - and why does releasing it frighten me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one thing that has grown too heavy to carry while following Christ, and take one concrete step today to loosen your grip on it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You beheld that rich young man and loved him before You asked for anything, and I trust that You look at me the same way -" finish the line in your own words.

When Following Jesus Divides the House

DAY 283

MATTHEW 10:35 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 573

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:35?

- ② Where has my hunger for a loved one's approval tempted me to soften my obedience to Christ into silence?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one relationship where faithfulness to Jesus is costing you understanding, and today take one gentle, truthful step that honors Him without cruelty.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You told me the truth that following You might divide even my own house, and I thank You for not hiding the cost -" finish the line in your own words.

Peace Be with All Who Are in Christ

DAY 284

1 PETER 5:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 575

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in 1 Peter 5:14?

- ② In what relationship within my church or family have I been protecting myself instead of carrying the peace of Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one fellow believer you have been keeping at a distance, and today greet them with genuine warmth or take one step to repair what pride has bruised.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your table of grace is not built by perfect people but by those learning to belong to You together -" finish the line in your own words.

Room Enough for the Little Ones

DAY 285

MATTHEW 19:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 577

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 19:13?

- ② Who are the tender or vulnerable people in my life I have been treating as interruptions to more important work?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, when someone needs your gentleness at an inconvenient moment, stop and make room for them the way Jesus made room for the children.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, forgive me for the times I have waved away the tender ones because my schedule felt too important -" finish the line in your own words.

They Did to Him Whatsoever They Wished

DAY 286

MARK 9:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 579

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:13?

- ② Where am I demanding to be understood or vindicated, and how would resting in God's approval change the way I carry that rejection?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one situation where faithfulness has been misunderstood, and today release your need to be vindicated to God, choosing to keep obeying without defending yourself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when I do right and get rejection instead of understanding, remind me that even Your messengers were mistreated, and none of it fell outside the Father's story -" finish the line in your own words.

Jesus Withdrew to a Lonely Place

DAY 287

MATTHEW 14:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 581

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:13?

- ② What grief have I rushed past or buried under busyness, and what would it look like to bring it honestly to the Father?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Today, take one deliberate pause - a quiet moment away from the noise - to name your sorrow before God instead of pressing on as if nothing happened.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when the heavy news came, You withdrew to a lonely place and let Your grief breathe, and still Your compassion remained -" finish the line in your own words.

Forbid Them Not

DAY 288

LUKE 18:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 583

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 18:16?

- ② When someone needs gentleness at an inconvenient time, do I become a door that welcomes them or a wall that hinders them from coming near?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one person you tend to overlook as too small or too inconvenient, and today go out of your way to welcome them.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You called the little children and would not let anyone hinder them, for the Kingdom belongs to such as these -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Opposition Wears a Familiar Face

DAY 289

MATTHEW 10:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 585

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:36?

- ② Where am I tempted to buy back peace with a loved one at the cost of my faithfulness to Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one household relationship that has become strained by your obedience to Jesus, and today choose one response that keeps your integrity and your kindness together.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You warned me in love that opposition can wear the most familiar face, and You said it ahead of time so it would not shatter me -" finish the line in your own words.

Where Human Calculation Ends

DAY 290

MARK 10:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 587

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:27?

- ② What have I already labeled impossible, and what would change if I stopped arguing with it and brought it into the presence of God's power?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one situation you have written off as hopeless, and today bring it deliberately to God in prayer, asking Him to do what you cannot.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have reached the end of what I can figure out, and the numbers will not work -"
finish the line in your own words.

From Him Who Is, and Was, and Is to Come

DAY 291

REVELATION 1:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 589

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:4?

- ② Which tense of my life feels most unstable right now - a tender past, a demanding present, or an uncertain future - and how does the God who holds all three change the way I face it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before the day's worries take over, begin today by receiving God's grace and peace in prayer, naming His faithfulness over your past, present, and future.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Eternal Father, before the day names me with its worries, let me receive Your grace and peace -" finish the line in your own words.

They Fell on Their Faces, Sore Afraid

DAY 292

MATTHEW 17:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 591

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:6?

- ② What am I trembling before right now, and have I been ashamed of my fear instead of bringing it honestly to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one fear you have been hiding behind a brave face, and today confess it plainly to God, asking Him to draw near and steady you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, sometimes Your nearness lays me flat and I tremble like Your disciples on the mountain -" finish the line in your own words.

Receive the Kingdom as a Little Child

DAY 293

MARK 10:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 593

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:15?

- ② Where is the need to appear sufficient or impressive keeping me from receiving God's grace with childlike, open hands?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one area where you have been striving to earn what God offers freely, and today practice receiving it as a gift - through a simple prayer of dependence rather than performance.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I am tired of trying to earn what You want to give -" finish the line in your own words.

He Will Not Break the Bruised Reed

DAY 294

MATTHEW 12:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 595

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:20?

- ② Where do I feel like a bruised reed or a smoking wick right now, and have I been bracing for a blow instead of trusting the gentle hands of Christ?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one fragile place in your life you have been hiding, and today bring it openly to Jesus, letting His gentleness hold it instead of pretending to be unbroken.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You are the Servant who will not break the bruised reed or quench the smoking flax -" finish the line in your own words.

The Blind and the Lame Came to Him

DAY 295

MATTHEW 21:14 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 597

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:14?

- ② Have I believed I must arrive polished and whole to come to Jesus, and where has my own heart become too busy for someone else's need?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one real weakness to Jesus in worship today, and then make room for one other hurting person to draw near - a call, a welcome, a listening ear.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, in the temple You had just cleared, the blind and the lame came to You and You healed them -" finish the line in your own words.

What Would You That I Should Do for You?

DAY 296

MARK 10:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 599

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:36?

- ② What desire have I dressed up in spiritual language or hidden even from myself, and what would it mean to name it plainly before Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Tell Jesus honestly today what you really want, without spiritual disguise, and then choose one hidden act of faithfulness instead of grasping for recognition.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You asked those ambitious men what they wanted, and You ask me the same -"
finish the line in your own words.

From the Beginning It Was Not So

DAY 297

MATTHEW 19:8 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 601

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 19:8?

- ② What hard place in my heart have I quietly accepted as normal - a resentment, a cynicism, a sharpness - that Jesus wants to name and soften?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one place where your heart has grown guarded, confess it to Jesus without despair, and take one tender step today - a softer word, a small act of grace.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You named hardness of heart plainly and reached back past every broken concession to what God desired from the beginning -" finish the line in your own words.

He Rebuked It and Gave the Child Back

DAY 298

LUKE 9:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 603

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:42?

- ② What has been tearing at my life or my family that I have been measuring by my own exhausted strength instead of Christ's authority?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name the thing that has worn you thin, and today bring it first to Jesus in prayer - beholding His authority and mercy before you take another step to address it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, when the tormented boy was still coming, the enemy threw him down, but one word from You ended it - You healed the child and gave him back to his father -" finish the line in your own words.

Mercy Under Watchful Eyes

DAY 299

MATTHEW 12:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 605

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:10?

- ② Where has the fear of criticism or accusation made me less merciful than Christ is calling me to be?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one act of mercy you have held back for fear of what others might think, and today do it anyway, seeing the person the way Jesus did.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, in that synagogue the critics watched to accuse You, but You saw the suffering man and healed him without flinching -" finish the line in your own words.

Speak to Your Mountain and Do Not Waver

DAY 300

MARK 11:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 607

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:23?

- ② Where am I praying about a mountain while secretly rehearsing why God probably will not move it, and what would it look like to bring that divided heart honestly to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one mountain out loud to God today in a single believing sentence, and refuse to add the usual "but it will never change."

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that no mountain in my life is stronger than Your word -" finish the line in your own words.

Wake Up and Remember What You Were Given

DAY 301

REVELATION 3:3 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 609

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:3?

- ② In what area has my walk with Jesus quietly slipped from fire into habit, and what did it feel like back when He was near?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one specific way God first met you, and let that memory pull you into one honest, unhurried time of prayer today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to wake me before I lose what You have given -"
finish the line in your own words.

Love That Tells the Truth Before the Reckoning

DAY 302

MATTHEW 23:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 611

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 23:36?

- ② What have I been careful not to look at in my own heart, and how might Jesus be showing it to me out of grief rather than contempt?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Ask the Spirit to name one place your compassion has grown thin, then confess it honestly today instead of explaining it away.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to tell me the truth -" finish the line in your own words.

Buildings Impress, but Only His Presence Holds DAY 303

MARK 13:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 613

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:1?

- ② If one of the visible things I rely on cracked tomorrow, would my peace crack with it, and what does that reveal about my true foundation?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one "impressive stone" you have quietly trusted, and today thank God for it while deliberately placing your security back on Christ.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being the foundation that never falls -" finish the line in your own words.

The Peace You Carry Is Not the Peace You Force DAY 304

MATTHEW 10:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 615

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:13?

- ② Who am I wearing myself out trying to force into peace with me, and what would it look like to offer it sincerely and release the outcome to God?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Enter one difficult room or conversation today as a peace-bearer, saying your kind word once and refusing to strive for the response.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that I can carry Your peace without forcing anyone to receive it -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

October in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from October speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 274 • MATTHEW 22:5 + GENESIS 25:34

The Quiet No That Still Declines a King

He ate, rose, and walked away. Esau despised his birthright without a speech - he ate, drank, rose up, and went his way. The invited guests do the same, letting a farm and a ledger outweigh the feast of a King.

DAY 289 • MATTHEW 10:36 + JEREMIAH 12:6

When the Opposition Wears a Familiar Face

God's servants know this ache. God warned Jeremiah that even his own brothers would speak fair words and deal treacherously - and Jesus tells His disciples the same hard truth without flinching. Faithfulness sometimes costs the approval of the people closest to us, and the Lord says so in advance so it will not break us.

DAY 304 • MATTHEW 10:13 + ISAIAH 57:19

The Peace You Carry Is Not the Peace You Force

Peace to the far and near. The LORD says He Himself creates the greeting - "Peace, peace to him that is far off, and to him that is near" - and Jesus puts that very word in His messengers' mouths at the doorstep. We carry the peace; we were never asked to force it.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from October keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

NOVEMBER

Following Through the Hard Road

Stay with Jesus when obedience is costly and slow.

NOVEMBER • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
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29	30					

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Revelation
- ☐ 1 Peter
- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Luke

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

When Grief Has Somewhere Holy to Go

DAY 305

MATTHEW 14:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 617

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 14:12?

- ② What loss have I been hiding behind busyness or a forced smile instead of bringing honestly to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Set aside a few quiet minutes today to tell Jesus the whole truth of one grief you are carrying, holding nothing back.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that I do not have to carry my grief alone or pretend I am fine -" finish the line in your own words.

The Answer That Hid Behind "We Cannot Tell"

DAY 306

MARK 11:33 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 619

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:33?

- ② Where have I been "careful but not honest" with God, praying about something I already know the answer to, or softening a conviction so I never have to obey it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing you have been evading, say it plainly to God today, and take the first honest step you have been avoiding.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to see through my careful evasions -" finish the line in your own words.

The Farewell That Is Really a Promise to Return

DAY 307

MATTHEW 23:39 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 621

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 23:39?

- ② Over which unturned heart or long delay am I tempted to give up hope, and how does Jesus' word "till" reopen the story for me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Speak a fresh, believing prayer today for one person you had almost stopped praying for, keeping open the door that Jesus left open.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You do not say "never" over the ones I love; You say "till." When I grieve over hearts that resist You, keep me from closing the door You have... -" finish the line in your own words.

The Brother Who Suffers Beside You, Not Above You

DAY 308

REVELATION 1:9 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 623

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:9?

- ② Where has hardship made me believe God has abandoned me, and how does John's phrase "companion in tribulation" speak to that lie?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out to one brother or sister today - to lean on them, or to stand beside them in their trial - refusing to endure alone.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that hardship is not proof You have left me -" finish the line in your own words.

The Coming That Fills the Sky and Needs No Rumor

DAY 309

MATTHEW 24:27 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 625

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 24:27?

- ② Which fearful or sensational voices have I let rule my peace, and what would calm, unhurried watchfulness look like instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one source of anxious noise to step away from today, and replace that time with a few minutes resting in Jesus' steadiness.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your return will fill the sky and need no rumor to announce it -"
finish the line in your own words.

Endurance Rooted in His Name, Not in Resentment

DAY 310

MARK 13:13 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 627

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:13?

- ② Where has rejection for my faith tempted me to grow hard or build an identity around being disliked, and how can I let Jesus' name define me instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

In one situation where you feel like the outsider today, choose a tender response over a bitter one, and quietly entrust the reaction to Jesus.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your name is worth more than any approval I could lose -" finish the line in your own words.

He Speaks Restoration Into What Looks Tangled DAY 311

MATTHEW 17:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 629

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:11?

- ② What tangled place have I quietly decided is beyond repair, and how does Jesus' promise to "restore all things" challenge that verdict?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one broken or disordered situation to God today and ask Him to begin its restoration, taking one small step toward mending it yourself.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are not intimidated by anything tangled in my life -" finish the line in your own words.

Faithful in a Very Little, Trusted With Much

DAY 312

LUKE 19:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 631

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 19:17?

- ② What "very little" am I tempted to despise because it feels hidden or unimportant, and how might God be honoring my faithfulness there?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one small, unseen act of faithfulness today with your whole heart, as worship to the Master rather than for anyone's applause.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that nothing done faithfully for You is ever too small to be seen -" finish the line in your own words.

The Blessing That Comes Through Welcoming Another

DAY 313

MATTHEW 10:41 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 633

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:41?

- ② Whose God-given gift have I resented or been slow to honor, and what fear is underneath that reluctance to make room for them?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Genuinely honor one person today for the way God is using them, with a specific word of encouragement or a door opened on their behalf.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your table is never threatened by one more faithful servant -" finish the line in your own words.

When the Things We Use Begin to Use Us

DAY 314

MARK 10:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 635

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:23?

- ② What am I holding so tightly that surrendering it would feel like losing my life, and how has that grip begun to use me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one comfort, plan, or possession you have clutched, and take one concrete step today to hold it with an open hand before God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to show me what has quietly grown too heavy to carry -" finish the line in your own words.

Discernment Is Trusting That God Has Gone Ahead

DAY 315

MATTHEW 10:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 637

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:11?

- ② Where am I scattering myself thin trying to be everywhere, and where might Jesus actually be asking me to enquire, settle, and abide?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one thing that is not truly your assignment and release it today, so you can be faithfully present where God has sent you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You go ahead of me and prepare the welcome before I arrive -"
finish the line in your own words.

When Faithfulness Feels Too Costly to Receive

DAY 316

MATTHEW 19:10 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 639

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 19:10?

- ② Which commitment have I been quietly recalculating as "not worth it," and how might Jesus be calling it back to the goodness He designed?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one concrete step to honor a commitment you have been tempted to abandon, trusting God for the grace to keep it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You never make faithfulness heavier than the grace You supply -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Questions What We Ask For

DAY 317

MARK 10:38 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 641

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:38?

- ② What have I been asking God for that feels like significance, and am I reaching for the crown while stepping around the cup?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one ambition to Jesus today and honestly ask Him to show you the "cup" - the service or cost - it truly involves, then surrender it to His way.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me too much to simply hand me everything I ask for -" finish the line in your own words.

The Two-Talent Servant and the Same "Well Done"

DAY 318

MATTHEW 25:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 643

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:22?

- ② Whose "five talents" am I comparing myself to, and how has that comparison tempted me to bury the two I was actually given?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one gift or resource you have downplayed because it seems small, and put it faithfully to use today without comparing it to anyone else's.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You measure my faithfulness against what You actually gave me, never against someone else's story -" finish the line in your own words.

The Chief Shepherd Sees Every Hidden Labor

DAY 319

1 PETER 5:4 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 645

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in 1 Peter 5:4?

- ② Where am I laboring unseen and tempted to believe it is wasted, and how does the Chief Shepherd's watching eye change how I carry it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Keep serving faithfully in one hidden place today, and let yourself be shepherded too - receive encouragement, rest, or prayer instead of only giving.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, my Chief Shepherd, thank You that no hidden hour of my service escapes Your eye -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Comes Carrying His Own Reward

DAY 320

REVELATION 22:12 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 647

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:12?

- ② Where have I been laboring faithfully in the dark, quietly wondering whether it counts to anyone, and what changes if I truly believe Jesus is coming with my reward in His own hand?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one hidden act of faithfulness you can do today with no witness and no reward but His, and do it as unto the coming Christ.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are coming, and coming quickly, with Your reward in Your own hand -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Comes at the Hour You Stopped Watching DAY 321

MATTHEW 24:50 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 649

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 24:50?

- ② In the seasons when God has felt far and the answer slow, what has my heart quietly done, and would Jesus find me leaning toward Him or drifting from Him if He arrived today?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one area where delay has made you careless, and take one concrete step today to live it as though the Master were already in the room.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You know what my heart does in the long waiting when I forget You are near -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Christ They Questioned With Their Minds Made Up

DAY 322

MARK 12:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 651

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 12:18?

- ② What settled conclusion have I stopped bringing to Jesus because I already decided the answer, and what fear might really be hiding underneath it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one closed-off area of your life to God in prayer today as an honest question, not a defended verdict.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess I sometimes come to You with my mind already made up, defending my fears instead of seeking Your face -" finish the line in your own words.

The Servant Who Brought Back More Than He Was Given DAY 323

MATTHEW 25:20 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 653

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:20?

- ② Where has God grown real fruit through me that I have been afraid to name, and can I hold it up as gratitude rather than pride or false modesty?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Thank God today for one thing He has grown through your faithfulness, naming the gift before the gain.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for trusting me with anything at all -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Told Them Not to Make Him Known

DAY 324

MATTHEW 12:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 655

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:16?

- ② Where am I letting the need to be seen drive my obedience, and what would change if I trusted that the Father honors the faithfulness no one applauds?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one good thing today deliberately in secret, telling no one, offering it only to God.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, You had every reason to be seen and still chose to stay hidden until Your Father's hour -" finish the line in your own words.

The Prophet Herod Bound in Prison

DAY 325

MARK 6:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 657

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:17?

- ② Where has faithfulness cost me something, and have I let that hard place make me bitter or draw me closer to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one painful, unresolved consequence of doing right to God in honest prayer today, turning your heart toward Him from inside it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You do not hide the cost of faithfulness or pretend injustice away -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Son Who Came to Save What Was Lost

DAY 326

MATTHEW 18:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 659

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 18:11?

- ② Who has become invisible to me lately, and how might Jesus be asking me to see them the way His seeking heart sees the lost?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Reach out today to one person who has been overlooked, and let them know they are seen.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You came to seek and to save the lost, and that Your search still walks into houses and calls us by name -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Grieved and Still Said, Bring Him Here

DAY 327

LUKE 9:41 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 661

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 9:41?

- ② Have I been mistaking Jesus' correction for His rejection, and what hurting part of me have I kept hidden from Him out of fear?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring to Jesus today the one thing you have been ashamed to show Him, trusting Him to receive it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your rebuke and Your mercy come from the same loving heart -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Sends You On When the Door Slams

DAY 328

MATTHEW 10:23 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 663

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 10:23?

- ② Where has a door recently closed on me, and am I reading it as defeat when Jesus might be sending me on to the next assignment?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one practical step today toward the next city God may be opening, releasing the door that closed.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that a closed door is not the end of my usefulness to You -" finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Defends the One Cast Aside

DAY 329

MARK 10:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 665

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:11?

- ② In the tender areas of covenant, desire, and past hurt, where do I need Jesus to bring truth, and where do I need to receive that He defends the wounded, including me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring one relationship wound, one you caused or one you suffered, to Jesus today, asking Him for repentance or comfort as needed.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your truth about covenant is never a weapon but a shield for the wounded -" finish the line in your own words.

The Master Who Returns to Settle Accounts

DAY 330

MATTHEW 25:19 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 667

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:19?

- ② Where does the thought of giving an account to Jesus make me want to hide, and how does it change things to know the Judge is the same Lord who first entrusted me?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Honestly review one area of stewardship today, whether time, gifts, relationships, or resources, in prayer, inviting Jesus to show what is growing and what needs tending.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You will not audit me from a cold distance but sit down with me, face to face, as the Master who trusted me first -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Will Not Blot Out Your Name

DAY 331

REVELATION 3:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 669

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 3:5?

- ② Where has my faith grown dull or divided while still looking alive, and what would it mean to truly believe Jesus will never blot out my name?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one sleepy area of your walk and take one waking step of renewed faithfulness in it today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You will never, no never, blot my name from Your book, and that You will confess it before the Father and His angels -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Moved On to the Next Shore

DAY 332

MATTHEW 15:39 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 671

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:39?

- ② What ending or transition am I mistaking for abandonment, and how does it change things to see Jesus already steering me toward the next shore?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one after-moment you are in, and take one small step of trust toward what is next instead of clinging to what ended.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that when one scene closes, You are not closing Your heart toward me -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Spoke the Cross Out Loud

DAY 333

MARK 8:32 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 673

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:32?

- ② Where might my desire to protect myself or someone I love actually be fear resisting the obedience God is asking, and how can I surrender that instinct to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one place fear has been talking you or someone you love out of costly obedience, and take one step of surrender to God's will today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You spoke the cross plainly and never let fear turn You aside -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Son of Man Who Sows the Good Seed

DAY 334

MATTHEW 13:37 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 675

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 13:37?

- ② What field have I been carrying as if the whole outcome depended on me, and what would rest look like if I truly trusted the Son of Man to grow it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one outcome you have been anxiously controlling, and in prayer today hand it back to Jesus the Sower, taking one faithful step and releasing the rest.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are the Sower of every good thing, and the field is Yours, not mine to carry alone -" finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

November in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from November speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 305 • MATTHEW 14:12 + ACTS 8:2

When Grief Has Somewhere Holy to Go

Great lamentation is allowed here. John's friends bury their teacher and go straight to tell Jesus; Stephen's friends carry him to burial with great lamentation. From the beginning, God's people have been permitted to grieve loudly and bring the whole sorrow to the Lord.

DAY 320 • REVELATION 22:12 + ISAIAH 62:11

The Christ Who Comes Carrying His Own Reward

His reward is with Him. Isaiah told Zion to look up - salvation comes, and his reward is with him; the risen Jesus takes those very words on His own lips at the Bible's closing page. The hope is not vague: the Rewarder Himself is what arrives.

DAY 334 • MATTHEW 13:37 + 1 CORINTHIANS 3:5

The Son of Man Who Sows the Good Seed

Sowers serve; the Son owns. Jesus names Himself the sower of the good seed; Paul shrinks the workers down to size - who is Paul, who is Apollos, but ministers as the Lord gave. The field never belonged to the field hands, and that is the workers' rest.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from November keeps returning to you, and why?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

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DECEMBER

Resurrection Hope

Walk into the future with the risen Christ.

DECEMBER • JOURNAL UTILITY

This Month With God

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
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8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

WHERE WE READ THIS MONTH

- ☐ Matthew
- ☐ Luke
- ☐ 1 Peter

- ☐ Mark
- ☐ Revelation

SKETCH • NOTE • DRAW WHAT YOU HEAR

The Christ Who Gave Thanks Over Not Enough

DAY 335

MATTHEW 15:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 677

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:36?

- ② Where am I withholding gratitude until the math adds up, and what would it look like to thank God over my not enough and place it in His hands?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Give thanks today over one area where you feel you don't have enough, and take one step of offering that little to God for His use.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You gave thanks over the loaves before there was visibly enough -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Lord Who Told You to Shake Off the Dust

DAY 336

MARK 6:11 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 679

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:11?

- ② What rejection or slight have I been dragging with me instead of shaking off, and can I trust God to judge it rightly so I don't have to carry it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one grudge you have been rehearsing, and today deliberately shake off the dust, releasing it to God in prayer and taking a step forward.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You told Your disciples to shake off the dust and trust the Father with the judgment -" finish the line in your own words.

The Stone the Builders Threw Away

DAY 337

LUKE 20:17 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 681

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 20:17?

- ② Where has someone's rejection quietly become my verdict on myself, and how does it change things to know God overrules the builders' no?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one hope you abandoned because of a rejection, and take one step today to offer it back to God, trusting His verdict over theirs.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that the very stone the builders rejected became the head of the corner, and that human rejection never gets the final word with the Father -" finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Gathers What the World Scatters

DAY 338

MATTHEW 12:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 683

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:30?

- ② Where have I been living on the fence, mistaking a divided heart for a safe one, and what is Jesus asking me to gather back to Him?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one loyalty or area you have kept scattered from Christ, and take one concrete step today to gather it under His Lordship.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are the Gatherer who draws scattered lives into one fold -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Is Coming Quickly

DAY 339

REVELATION 22:7 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 685

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:7?

- ② Does the nearness of Jesus' coming make me anxious or glad, and what would it look like for my readiness to be peaceful love rather than fearful panic?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Live today with one deliberate act of leaning toward the door, keeping one of Jesus' words as life in a specific, practical way.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are coming quickly, and that Your nearness is a blessing, not a threat -" finish the line in your own words.

When Guilt Hears a Ghost Instead of the Gospel

DAY 340

MARK 6:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 687

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 6:16?

- ② What old sin or failure does my conscience keep resurrecting, and how would my heart change if I truly believed Christ has already buried it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one thing you have been dreading God's judgment over, confess it plainly to Him today, and thank Him aloud that the blood of Jesus has already answered it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Heavenly Father, thank You that the resurrection I once feared is the mercy that sets me free -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Master Trusts You With a Fortune Before He Leaves

DAY 341

MATTHEW 25:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 689

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 25:15?

- ② What gift, resource, or opportunity have I been calling 'too small,' and how does it change things to hear the Master call it a fortune?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take the one 'talent' you have been burying and put it to work today in a single concrete way - one call, one word, one act of service.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for measuring my gift to my own hand and trusting me with it -" finish the line in your own words.

Jesus Does Not Expel the Slow Learner

DAY 342

MATTHEW 15:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 691

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:16?

- ② Where have I been ashamed of how slowly I am growing, and what would change if I saw that slowness as being kept in Christ's classroom rather than failing it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one truth you know but have not yet lived; bring it back to Jesus in prayer today and ask Him to teach it to your heart, not just your head.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for being patient with a slow heart like mine -" finish the line in your own words.

Your Risen Lord Is Not Lost, So Stop Chasing Him

DAY 343

MARK 13:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 693

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:21?

- ② What voice or promise have I been anxiously chasing lately, and what would it look like to lean my full weight on Christ instead of running after certainty?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one 'here is Christ, there is Christ' voice pulling at you today - a person, a feed, a fear - and deliberately step off that chase to sit quietly with the Lord who is already near.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You are not hidden and never lost -" finish the line in your own words.

The Question Jesus Will Not Let You Answer Vaguely

DAY 344

MATTHEW 22:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 695

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:42?

- ② Where has my picture of Jesus stayed small and manageable, and what part of my life am I still editing because I have not let Him be Lord?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write in your own words - not borrowed ones - who Jesus truly is to you, and name one area you will surrender to Him as King today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for pressing me past secondhand answers into real recognition of who You are -" finish the line in your own words.

The Sign of Jonah Points Straight to an Empty Tomb

DAY 345

LUKE 11:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 697

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 11:30?

- ② Where does fear keep telling me 'this is the end,' and how does the sign of Jonah reframe the dark place I am in right now?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name the 'three dark days' you are living through, and write one sentence of trust that God is preparing a resurrection there - then read it aloud when the fear returns.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for the sign of Jonah - for going down into death so I would never face the dark alone -" finish the line in your own words.

The Question That Turns the Light on Every Heart

DAY 346

MARK 11:29 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 699

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:29?

- ② What question have I been pressing on God while unwilling to surrender to His answer, and what am I really trying to keep control of?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Let Jesus ask you one honest question today: 'What are you truly after?' Write your answer plainly, and surrender the area where you have been demanding control.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that Your authority is real and Your light is kind -" finish the line in your own words.

Every Broken Thing Laid at His Feet Was Healed DAY 347

MATTHEW 15:30 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 701

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:30?

- ② What wound have I been hiding and calling 'handled,' and what holds me back from casting it down at the feet of Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one broken place you keep covered, and today bring it honestly to Jesus in prayer - and, if He leads, to one trusted person who can pray with you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You bend over every broken thing laid at Your feet -" finish the line in your own words.

Peter Leads From What He Saw, Not From His Rank

DAY 348

1 PETER 5:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 703

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in 1 Peter 5:1?

- ② Where am I leading or relating from 'above' - proving and self-protecting - and how would nearness and humble witness change it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Choose one relationship where you have been guarding your position, and today step in beside that person as a fellow servant rather than an authority over them.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that true authority comes not from rank but from beholding You -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Great Commandment Is a Love to Live Inside

DAY 349

MATTHEW 22:36 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 705

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 22:36?

- ② What is pulling my heart apart right now, and how would my day reorder itself if I asked 'what does love require first?' instead of 'what is most urgent?'

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before you tackle your list today, name the one thing love for God or a person truly requires first - and do that first.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for showing me the great commandment - the love I am made to live inside -" finish the line in your own words.

The Hidden Leaven That Flavors a Whole Heart

DAY 350

MARK 8:15 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 707

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 8:15?

- ② What small, hidden attitude have I been quietly feeding, and how has it started to flavor the way I see God and other people?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'leaven' - a replayed hurt, a suspicion, a pride - and today bring it deliberately into the light: confess it and ask Christ to purge it before it spreads.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for warning me about the leaven I would rather ignore -" finish the line in your own words.

God Builds Perfect Praise From the Smallest Voices

DAY 351

MATTHEW 21:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 709

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 21:16?

- ② Where have I held back my worship because I felt too small, unqualified, or unimpressive to offer it?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Offer God deliberate praise today exactly as you are - spoken, sung, or written - without waiting to feel worthy of it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for receiving the praise of the small and refusing to silence it -" finish the line in your own words.

The Firstborn From the Dead Who Washed Us in His Blood

DAY 352

REVELATION 1:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 711

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 1:5?

- ② Do I picture God's power as cold and distant, or as the redeeming reign of the One who washed me in His blood - and how would the second picture change my week?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Before the demands of the day begin, name aloud who Jesus is from this verse and tell Him He is already enough for whatever comes.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, faithful witness, firstborn from the dead, Prince of the kings of the earth - thank You that You loved me and washed me from my sins in Your own blood -" finish the line in your own words.

The Faith That Would Not Leave the Feet of Jesus

DAY 353

MATTHEW 15:28 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 713

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:28?

- ② What have I been tempted to stop praying for because the silence felt like a 'no' - and what would it look like to stay at the feet of Jesus a little longer?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Return to a prayer you nearly gave up on and bring it to Jesus again today, deliberately, trusting His delay is not His denial.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You call persistent faith great and answer it in full -" finish the line in your own words.

They Set a Trap, and Jesus Answered the Heart

DAY 354

MARK 10:2 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 715

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 10:2?

- ② Have I been using truth or Scripture to win or wound, and where is there a tangled hurt I need to bring humbly under Jesus' authority instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one hard situation you have been arguing about rather than surrendering, and bring it to Jesus in prayer today, asking for truth that heals rather than a point to win.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that You answer the heart, not just the argument -" finish the line in your own words.

You Cannot Earn What Can Only Be Inherited

DAY 355

LUKE 18:18 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 717

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 18:18?

- ② Where am I still trying to earn God's love or acceptance by doing, and what would change if I truly received it as an inheritance instead?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one way you have been 'clocking in' to earn God's favor, and today deliberately rest in His grace instead - thank Him for a gift you cannot buy.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that eternal life is an inheritance I receive, not a wage I earn -" finish the line in your own words.

The Name Big Enough for the People You Wrote Off

DAY 356

MATTHEW 12:21 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 719

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:21?

- ② Who have I quietly decided is beyond the reach of grace, and what does it mean that the hope of the nations hangs on the very name of Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one person you had written off and begin praying for them again today, trusting that His name reaches farther than your map.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that in Your name the far-off find hope -" finish the line in your own words.

Take Heed - Deception Is a Road Quietly Left

DAY 357

MARK 13:5 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 721

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 13:5?

- ② Am I more tempted toward gullibility or toward suspicious hardness right now, and how can staying close to Christ's voice keep me grounded between the two?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'confident voice' currently pulling at you, and today test it against what you know of Jesus in Scripture before you take another step toward it.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for guarding the road and warning me to take heed -" finish the line in your own words.

The Experts Came to Inspect the Word Made Flesh

DAY 358

MATTHEW 15:1 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 723

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 15:1?

- ② Whose critical eye tempts me to either shrink or turn cruel, and how can I stay 'alive to truth without surrendering my soul to accusation' the way Jesus did?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Identify one relationship where scrutiny has been stealing your peace, and today choose one response that is both honest and kind rather than fearful or cruel.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You that under the sharpest scrutiny You never became small, frantic, or cruel -" finish the line in your own words.

A Word You Can Put Your Whole Weight On

DAY 359

REVELATION 22:6 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 725

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Revelation 22:6?

- ② Whose version of my future am I leaning on more right now - fear's forecast or God's faithful word - and where do I need to shift my weight?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write down one promise of God that speaks to your current fear, and today choose to act on it as if it is faithful and true, because it is.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, faithful and true, thank You that Your word can bear the full weight of my fear -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Christ Who Gave the Silent Man Back His Voice

DAY 360

MATTHEW 12:22 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 727

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 12:22?

- ② Where in my life have I gone silent - a hope I stopped speaking, a prayer I stopped praying - and what would it look like to bring that shut-up place honestly to Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Name one 'muted' area out loud to God today, and ask one trusted person to carry it to Jesus in prayer with you.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I bring You the places in me that have gone silent and blind -" finish the line in your own words.

Better One Eye in the Kingdom Than Two in the Fire

DAY 361

MARK 9:47 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 729

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 9:47?

- ② What is the one thing I keep excusing that Jesus is asking me to release - and what am I really afraid I will lose if I let it go?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Take one concrete step today to cut off an 'offending eye' - delete it, block it, confess it, or hand it to an accountable friend.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for loving me enough to tell me the truth -" finish the line in your own words.

Carry to Jesus What No One Else Could Cure

DAY 362

MATTHEW 17:16 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 731

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 17:16?

- ② Where have I let 'it didn't work' harden into 'it never will,' and how might carrying that need directly to Jesus reopen my hope?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Bring back to God in prayer today the one need you had given up on, naming it plainly the way the father did.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I have taken my need to every place I knew and still come home carrying it -"
finish the line in your own words.

The Faithful Steward Who Serves the Portion on Time

DAY 363

LUKE 12:42 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 733

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Luke 12:42?

- ② What ordinary 'portion' has Jesus entrusted to me right now, and am I serving it faithfully or despising it while I wait for something bigger?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Do one entrusted task today - a meal, a call, a repair, a kindness - deliberately and on time, as service to Christ.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, thank You for trusting me with a household and a portion to serve -" finish the line in your own words.

The Truth They Reasoned Their Way Around

DAY 364

MARK 11:31 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 735

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Mark 11:31?

- ② What honest answer have I been avoiding because of what saying yes would cost me - and what is that evasion doing to my walk with Jesus?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Answer one question you have been dodging today: say the honest 'yes' or confession out loud to God, and take the first step it requires.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, I confess how often I already know the truth and spend my strength avoiding it -"
finish the line in your own words.

Lord, That Our Eyes May Be Opened

DAY 365

MATTHEW 20:33 • SEE DEVOTIONAL P. 737

- ① What word, action, promise, warning, or picture stands out in Matthew 20:33?

- ② Where have I dressed up my prayers to avoid saying what I really need - and what would it look like to bring Jesus one plain, honest request as this year ends?

ONE SMALL STEP TODAY

Write one direct, undecorated prayer for the year ahead - 'Lord, open my eyes about ____' - and pray it out loud today.

WRITTEN-PRAYER STARTER

"Lord Jesus, risen and alive, I bring You the plain prayer of two blind men: open my eyes -"
finish the line in your own words.

CORRELATIVE WEAVE • LOOK BACK, LISTEN FORWARD

December in Conversation

Pause before turning the page. Let three moments from December speak together, then name what God has made clearer in you.

DAY 335 • MATTHEW 15:36 + LUKE 22:19

The Christ Who Gave Thanks Over Not Enough

Four verbs, from hillside to table. On the hillside Jesus took, gave thanks, brake, and gave; in the upper room He does the same four things with the bread that is His body. Every thanksgiving over not-enough was rehearsing the Table where He Himself became enough.

DAY 350 • MARK 8:15 + 1 CORINTHIANS 5:6

The Hidden Leaven That Flavors a Whole Heart

A pinch is never just a pinch. Jesus warns of the leaven of the Pharisees and of Herod, and Paul states the kitchen fact plainly: a little leaven leavens the whole lump. Hidden influence never stays small - it spreads until the whole loaf tastes of it.

DAY 365 • MATTHEW 20:33 + PSALM 119:18

Lord, That Our Eyes May Be Opened

An old psalm on the Jericho road. Centuries before, the psalmist prayed the same plain sentence - open my eyes - asking to see wonders in God's Word. On the Jericho road two blind men pray it to the Word made flesh, and He stops, touches, and answers in person.

THE TRUTH I AM CARRYING

Which Scripture or title from December keeps returning to you, and why?

THE STEP THAT BECAME REAL

Which small act of obedience moved from intention into practice?

THE THREAD I CAN NOW SEE

Where did two passages begin answering each other in your life?

THE PRAYER FOR NEXT MONTH

What do you want the way of Jesus to reshape as you continue?

Father, gather what You have taught me this month. Show me the thread I nearly missed, strengthen the step I have begun, and carry Your word with me into what comes next. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture Pairing Index

Anchor and Thread for every day, with the devotional page where each pairing lives.

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